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SUPPLEMENT TO "ABS CHALLENGES: AN ACCOUNTING INDEX OF WINS LEFT ON THE TABLE": PROOFS, SYMBOLIC VERIFICATION AND ADDITIONAL RESULTS

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Section S1 proves Theorem 2 of the main text and the flat-optimum bound (Theorem S3), a square-root law for the value of a retained challenge (Theorem S2) and a comparison of retention with consumable challenges, and marks which statements are proved and which are numerical only. Section S2 lists the Mathematica checks behind the paper's algebra. Section S3 is the geometry and data audit, including the count-based join. Section S4 gives the decision models in full: every variant, player heterogeneity, the time-varying criterion, out-of-sample and minor-league fits, identification and the sensitivity of the wins lost to decision noise. Section S5 documents the policy evaluation: the competitor rules, the causal re-simulation (recorded-start and paired contrasts), the decomposition of the gap between the simulator and the WP engine, the flat-optimum bound on the calibrated pools, the validation of the stakes, the intervention grid, the bootstraps and the coverage study. Section S6 gives the 2026 postseason check in full, and Section S7 describes the exploratory cricket DRS application.

Equation, theorem and section numbers without the prefix S refer to the main text.

S1. Proofs. Each statement carries a status: [PROVED] means the proof is complete here and its algebraic steps are checked in Mathematica (Section S2); [PROVED, SKETCH] means the argument is complete but uses a standard lemma that is cited rather than reproduced; [NUMERICAL] means the statement rests on deterministic computation only. Table S2 at the end of the section collects them.

S1.1. *Setting.* Let t be the number of opportunities left and c the challenges held. At each opportunity a pair (p, g) with law F_t arrives: $g \geq 0$ is the stake and $p \in [0,1]$ the calibrated probability that a challenge succeeds. A successful challenge gains g and keeps the challenge; a failed one loses it. With $V_0(\cdot) = V_t(0) = 0$ the value of challenging at (t, c) is $p\{g + V_{t-1}(c)\} + (1-p)V_{t-1}(c-1) = V_{t-1}(c) + pg - (1-p)\Delta_{t-1}(c)$ and the value of waiting is $V_{t-1}(c)$, which gives the Bellman equation (3),

$$V_t(c) = V_{t-1}(c) + \varphi_t\{\Delta_{t-1}(c)\}, \qquad \varphi_t(d) = \mathbb{E}_t\{(pg - (1-p)d)^+\},$$

and the cutoff (3): challenge iff $pg \geq (1-p)\Delta_{t-1}(c)$, that is $p \geq \Delta_{t-1}(c)/\{g + \Delta_{t-1}(c)\}$. The Q-gap between the two actions is

$$|pg - (1-p)D| = |p(g+D) - D|, \qquad D = \Delta_{t-1}(c). \tag{S1}$$

Throughout, $\psi_t(d) = d + \varphi_t(d)$. Since $V_t(0) = 0$, $\Delta_t(1) = V_t(1)$, and the Bellman equation gives

$$\Delta_t(1) = \psi_t\{\Delta_{t-1}(1)\}, \qquad \Delta_t(c) = \psi_t\{\Delta_{t-1}(c)\} - \varphi_t\{\Delta_{t-1}(c-1)\} \quad (c \geq 2). \tag{S2}$$

S1.2. *Monotone thresholds.*

LEMMA S1 (PROVED). *For any law F of (p, g) on $[0,1] \times [0,\infty)$ with $\mathbb{E}g < \infty$, $\varphi(d) = \mathbb{E}\{(pg - (1-p)d)^+\}$ is nonnegative and nonincreasing on $[0,\infty)$, with difference quotients in $[-1,0]$, and $\psi(d) = d + \varphi(d)$ is nondecreasing.*

PROOF. Fix (p, g). The map $j(x) = (pg - (1-p)x)^+$ is the positive part of an affine function of slope $-(1-p) \in [-1,0]$, so it is nonnegative, nonincreasing, and its difference quotients lie in $[-(1-p), 0] \subset [-1,0]$. Then $x + j(x)$ has difference quotients in $[0,1]$. Taking expectations (finite because $j(x) \le g$) preserves all three properties. □

Theorem 2 (main text). *Under Assumption 1, for all t and $c \ge 1$: (a) $\Delta_t(c) \ge \Delta_t(c+1) \ge 0$; (b) $\Delta_t(c) \ge \Delta_{t-1}(c)$.*

PROOF [PROVED]. By induction on t. For $t = 0$, $\Delta_0 \equiv 0$ and both claims hold. Suppose they hold at $t-1$ and fix $c \ge 1$. Write $a = \Delta_{t-1}(c-1)$ (only for $c \ge 2$), $b = \Delta_{t-1}(c)$ and $e = \Delta_{t-1}(c+1)$; by hypothesis $a \ge b \ge e \ge 0$. Under Assumption 1 the same function φ_t applies at every c, so by (S2)

$$\Delta_t(c) = \psi_t(b) - \varphi_t(a), \qquad \Delta_t(c+1) = \psi_t(e) - \varphi_t(b),$$

with the $\varphi_t(a)$ term absent when $c = 1$. By Lemma S1, $\psi_t(b) \ge \psi_t(e)$ and $\varphi_t(b) \ge \varphi_t(a)$, so $\Delta_t(c) - \Delta_t(c+1) = \{\psi_t(b) - \psi_t(e)\} + \{\varphi_t(b) - \varphi_t(a)\} \ge 0$, which is (a). Next $\Delta_t(c) - \Delta_{t-1}(c) = \varphi_t(b) - \varphi_t(a) \ge 0$ (and $= \varphi_t(b) \ge 0$ for $c = 1$), which is (b); with $b \ge 0$ it also gives $\Delta_t(c) \ge 0$. The optimal cutoff $D/(g+D)$ is increasing in D (its derivative in D is $g/(g+D)^2 > 0$), so it falls as t decreases and rises as c decreases. □

REMARK S1 (Where the theorem fails). *A law that depends on c.* Let $g = 1$, $p = 1/10$ when one challenge is held and $p = 9/10$ when two are held. After five opportunities the exact DP gives $\Delta(1) = 0.111$ and $\Delta(2) = 3.61$, so V is convex in c: the second challenge is worth more than the first because holding it changes the opportunities themselves. Exogeneity in Assumption 1 cannot be dropped. *The score-aware DP used in the paper.* It is not the fixed-horizon problem of Theorem 2: the number of a team's remaining opportunities is random (empirical hazards), the score moves between half-innings, and the extra-inning top-up refills $c = 0$ to $c = 1$. Its computed continuation values need not be monotone, and they are not. At the comparator's fitted parameters (one simulated world), the first marginal value rises with the opportunity index at 20% of the visited (half-inning, score, index) entries, which carry 9% of the opportunities (a team that has survived to a later index in a half-inning faces a different remaining horizon), and $\Delta(1) < \Delta(2)$ at 0.6% of the entries (0.1% of opportunities), the top-up at the last regulation opportunity of the home side among them (src/extra_checks.py). The theorem describes the idealised problem; the threshold movements reported in the paper are computed, not deduced from it. *Exact random laws.* On 300 seeded random discrete laws (i.i.d. and time-varying, p and g dependent, retention and consumption) the exact rational DP satisfies both monotonicities in every case.

Relation to the stochastic knapsack. In Derman, Lieberman and Ross (1972) and Kleywegt and Papastavrou (1998) a unit of capacity is spent whenever an item is accepted, and the analogue of φ is $\mathbb{E}(pg - d)^+$. Under retention the unit is spent only on failure, so the continuation value enters the gain as $p(g + \Delta)$. The induction above uses only the properties in Lemma S1, which both gain functions share.

S1.3. *The square-root law.* Two identities drive the growth of Δ. First, $\Delta_t(1) = V_t(1)$. Second, by (S2),

$$\Delta_t(1)^2 - \Delta_{t-1}(1)^2 = \eta_t\big(\Delta_{t-1}(1)\big), \qquad \eta_t(d) = 2d\varphi_t(d) + \varphi_t(d)^2. \tag{S3}$$

THEOREM S2 ([PROVED]). *Under Assumption 1, let $c = 1$, $F_t = F$ for all t, $q = 1 - p$, and suppose that given g, q has a density $f(\cdot \mid g)$ near 0 with $f(0+ \mid g) = h(g)$, bounded by $M(g)$ on $[0, x_0]$ with $\mathbb{E}[g^2 M(g)] < \infty$, $\mathbb{E}g^2 < \infty$, and $K = \mathbb{E}[h(g)g^2]/2 \in (0, \infty)$. Then $\Delta_t(1) \sim \sqrt{\mathbb{E}[h(g)g^2]\, t}$.*

The exponent is set by how much probability sits near certainty, not by a moment condition: if $\mathbb{P}(q \le x \mid g) \sim c(g)x^\alpha$ the growth is $t^{1/(1+\alpha)}$, so an atom at $p = 1$ gives linear growth and a density vanishing linearly at 1 gives $t^{1/3}$ (Remark S2). Under consumption, by contrast, Δ never exceeds the largest expected single gain, so a retained challenge eventually beats any fixed number of consumable ones: with p uniform and $g = 1$ one retained challenge beats 2, 3 and 5 consumable ones for $t \ge 4$, 10 and 27 opportunities. In the main text the theorem only motivates why the value of a retained challenge is not bounded by a single stake; the calibrated game does not satisfy it (Remark S6).

PROOF [PROVED]. Write $\Delta_t = \Delta_t(1)$ and $\varphi = \varphi_t$.

Step 1: $\Delta_t \to \infty$. By Theorem 2(b), Δ_t is nondecreasing. If $\Delta_t \le L$ for all t, then by (S2) and Lemma S1, $\Delta_t = \Delta_{t-1} + \varphi(\Delta_{t-1}) \ge \Delta_{t-1} + \varphi(L)$, so $\Delta_t \ge t\varphi(L) \to \infty$, a contradiction as soon as $\varphi(L) > 0$. And $\varphi(L) = \mathbb{E}\{(g - q(g+L))^+\} > 0$ because $K > 0$ forces $h(g)g^2 > 0$ on a set of positive probability, on which q has positive density near 0, so that $q < g/(g+L)$ with positive probability.

Step 2: $d\varphi(d) \to K$ *as* $d \to \infty$. Since $pg - (1-p)d = g - q(g+d)$, the integrand is positive iff $q < g/(g+d)$. Let $c_0 = x_0/(1-x_0)$ and split $d\varphi(d) = A(d) + B(d)$ over $\{g \le c_0 d\}$ and $\{g > c_0 d\}$. On the first set $g/(g+d) \le x_0$, so the positive part only involves $q \in [0, x_0]$, where q has the density f, and substituting $q = ug/(g+d)$ (the integrand becomes $g(1-u)$ and $dq = g\,du/(g+d)$) gives

$$A(d) = \mathbb{E}\Big[\frac{dg^2}{g+d}\int_0^1 (1-u)\, f\Big(\frac{ug}{g+d}\,\Big|\, g\Big)du\,;\, g \le c_0 d\Big].$$

For fixed g and u the integrand converges to $g^2(1-u)h(g)$, whose expectation is K, and it is at most $g^2 M(g)/2$, so $A(d) \to K$ by dominated convergence. On the second set the density is not used: $B(d) = d\,\mathbb{E}[(g - q(g+d))^+;\, g > c_0 d] \le \mathbb{E}[dg;\, g > c_0 d] \le \mathbb{E}[g^2 \mathbf{1}\{g > c_0 d\}]/c_0 \to 0$. Hence $d\varphi(d) \to K$.

Step 3. By (S2), $\Delta_t^2 - \Delta_{t-1}^2 = \eta(\Delta_{t-1})$ with $\eta(d) = 2d\varphi(d) + \varphi(d)^2$ (identity (S3)). By Steps 1–2, $\varphi(\Delta_t) \to 0$ and $\eta(\Delta_t) \to 2K$, so by Cesàro $\Delta_t^2/t = t^{-1}\sum_{s \le t} \eta(\Delta_{s-1}) \to 2K$. □

Step 2 needs $\mathbb{E}g^2 < \infty$ to control the large-stake set. It holds trivially for stakes in win probability ($0 \le g \le 1$), and the statement includes it.

REMARK S2 (Other rates, [PROVED, SKETCH]; constants exact). If $\mathbb{P}(q \le x \mid g) \sim c(g)x^\alpha$, the same substitution gives $d^\alpha \varphi(d) \to K_\alpha = \mathbb{E}[c(g)g^{1+\alpha}]/(1+\alpha)$. By the mean value theorem $\Delta_t^{1+\alpha} - \Delta_{t-1}^{1+\alpha} = (1+\alpha)\xi^\alpha \varphi(\Delta_{t-1})$ with $\xi \in [\Delta_{t-1}, \Delta_t]$ and $\xi/\Delta_{t-1} \to 1$, so the increments converge to $(1+\alpha)K_\alpha$ and $\Delta_t \sim \{(1+\alpha)K_\alpha t\}^{1/(1+\alpha)}$. The domination step for $\alpha \ne 1$ is analogous to Step 2 and is not written out; it needs $\mathbb{E}[c(g)g^{1+\alpha}] < \infty$ and a local bound on $\mathbb{P}(q \le x \mid g)/x^\alpha$ that is integrable against $g^{1+\alpha}$, the analogues of the conditions of

Theorem S2. Numerically, at $t = 10^6$: with a positive finite density of p at 1 ($\alpha = 1$, $K_1 = 9/8$ exactly) $\Delta_t/\sqrt{2K_1 t} = 0.9986$; with a density vanishing linearly at 1 ($\alpha = 2$, $K_2 = 83/144$) $\Delta_t/(3K_2 t)^{1/3} = 0.985$; with an atom at $p = 1$ the growth is linear, $\Delta_t/t = 0.0917$ against the limit $\mathbb{E}[g; p = 1] = 11/120 = 0.0917$.

REMARK S3 (Time-varying laws, [PROVED, SKETCH]). If F_t varies with t, $K_t \in [K_{\min}, K_{\max}] \subset (0, \infty)$ and Step 2 holds uniformly in t, the same argument with weighted Cesàro sums gives $\Delta_t^2 / \sum_{s \le t} 2K_s \to 1$: the option value is the square root of the cumulative squared-stake mass. With stakes alternating between 1 and 3 and uniform p, the ratio is 0.9973 at $t = 10^6$.

REMARK S4 (More challenges, [HEURISTIC]; constants exact, convergence not proved). For $c \ge 2$, $\Delta_t(c) \sim k_c\sqrt{2Kt}$ with $k_1 = 1$ and $k_c^2 + k_c/k_{c-1} = 1$. Sketch: $\Delta_t(c) \to \infty$ by the argument of Step 1; $y_t = \Delta_t(c)^2/(2Kt)$ satisfies a deterministic stochastic-approximation recursion with step $1/t$ and drift $1 - \sqrt{y}/k_{c-1} - y + o(1)$, which is strictly decreasing with unique root k_c^2; the Robbins–Monro/Chung lemma (e.g. Kushner and Yin, 2003, Ch. 5) gives $y_t \to k_c^2$: the recursion is deterministic, its steps are $O(1/t)$, the drift is continuous and strictly decreasing with a unique root, and the $o(1)$ term comes from $\Delta_t(c-1)/\{k_{c-1}\sqrt{2Kt}\} \to 1$, the induction hypothesis; a full proof would write out that error bound. Hence $k_2 = (\sqrt{5} - 1)/2$, and $k_1, \dots, k_6 = 1.000, 0.618, 0.477, 0.401, 0.351, 0.316$. With uniform p and $g = 1$, $\Delta_t(c)/\sqrt{t}$ for $c = 1, \dots, 4$ at $t = 10^6$ is 0.9990, 0.6170, 0.4763, 0.3997.

REMARK S5 (Consumption, [PROVED]). Under consumption, $\Delta_t^{\mathrm{cons}}(c) \le s$ for all t, where $s = \operatorname{ess\,sup}(pg)$. The inductive step is $x \le s,\ Y \le s \Rightarrow x + \mathbb{E}(Y - x)^+ \le s$. With uniform p and $g = 1$, Δ^{cons} at $t = 10^6$ is 0.999998.

REMARK S6 (The calibrated game, [NUMERICAL]). In the calibrated 2026 DP, Δ_1 is of the same order as the stakes, so the game is pre-asymptotic. What carries over exactly is identity (S3): for uniform p, $\eta(d) = g^2(2d + g)^2/\{4(d + g)^2\}$ rises only from $g^2/4$ to g^2 as d/g goes from 0 to ∞, so Δ^2 is close to linear in the opportunities left even far from the asymptote. The calibrated p is concentrated near zero, where η varies much more, so for the calibrated game the near-linearity below is an empirical finding rather than a consequence of the identity. In the score-aware DP the score is part of the state, so the law of (p, g) is no longer exogenous; the object that Theorem S2 speaks to is the continuation value averaged over the score states the 2026 games actually visit. For that average, a linear fit of Δ_1^2 on the expected regulation opportunities left n has $R^2 = 0.9976$ (home) and 0.9975 (away), and $\Delta_1 \approx a + 0.0021\sqrt{n}$ has $R^2 = 0.9962$ and 0.9987, against 0.98 for a linear fit in n. Along a path held at a tied score the fit is poor (R^2 of 0.84–0.88): late in a tied game the continuation value stays high, because every remaining call matters. We therefore say that the option value *scales like* $\sqrt{n}$ on average over game states, not that it follows the asymptotic law; an R^2 near one on a smooth monotone curve discriminates only weakly between exponents, and the linearity of Δ^2 is what identity (S3) suggests. The ratio Δ_2/Δ_1 at the first pitch is 0.53–0.54, below the limit 0.618, as the pre-asymptotic iteration predicts.

S1.4. *The flat optimum.*

THEOREM S3 (flat optimum; (i) is the identity of Theorem 2). *Under Assumption 1: (i) exactly,*

$$V_T^\star(c_0) - V_T^\delta(c_0) = \sum_t \sum_{c \ge 1} \mathbb{P}^\delta(c_t = c)\, \mathbb{E}_g \int_{I_t(c,g)} |p(g + D) - D|\, dF_t(p \mid g).$$

(ii) If the conditional density of p on I_t is at most M, then $V_T^\star - V_T^\delta \le (M/2)\sum_t \sum_c \mathbb{P}^\delta(c_t = c)\,\mathbb{E}_g[g^2(D-\delta)^2/\{(g+D)(g+\delta)^2\}]$.

PROOF [PROVED]. (i) Let $Q_t^\star(c,a)$ be the value of taking action a at (t,c) and acting optimally afterwards, and V_t^δ the value of following ρ_δ. For the action $a = \rho_\delta(t,c,p,g)$,

$$V_t^\star(c) - V_t^\delta(c) = \{V_t^\star(c) - Q_t^\star(c,a)\} + \mathbb{E}\{V_{t-1}^\star(c') - V_{t-1}^\delta(c') \mid t,c,a\},$$

because $Q_t^\star(c,a)$ and the value of a under ρ_δ share the immediate reward and the transition to c' and differ only in the continuation. Unrolling from (T,c_0) along the trajectory of ρ_δ gives $V_T^\star(c_0) - V_T^\delta(c_0) = \mathbb{E}^\delta \sum_t \{V_t^\star(c_t) - Q_t^\star(c_t,a_t)\}$ (Kakade and Langford, 2002; Puterman, 1994). The bracket is zero when ρ_δ takes the optimal action and equals the Q-gap (S1) otherwise. With $c_t = c \ge 1$ the two rules differ exactly for p between $D/(g+D)$ and $\delta/(g+\delta)$, which is the interval $I_t(c,g)$. The Q-gap vanishes at the first endpoint. At the second, ρ_δ challenges when $p = \delta/(g+\delta)$ exactly (the convention of the policy code). If $\delta < D$ the rule then challenges where the optimum declines, so I_t is closed at $\delta/(g+\delta)$; if $\delta > D$ both challenge there, so I_t is open at it. With this convention (i) holds for any law of p, atoms included (for $g = D = 1$ and an atom at $p = 1/3$, $\delta = 1/2$ gives regret $1/3$; an atom at $p = 2/3$ with $\delta = 2$ gives none; checked in Mathematica, `wolfram/atom_endpoint.wl`). The values compared are those before (p,g) is observed at t; the decomposition conditions on (p,g) inside the expectation. Finally, c_t is a function of the past and by Assumption 1 the current (p,g) is independent of it, so conditioning on $c_t = c$ leaves the law F_t unchanged. States with $c = 0$ have no action and contribute nothing.

(ii) On $I_t(c,g)$ the Q-gap is $(g+D)|p - D/(g+D)|$, linear in p and zero at the endpoint $D/(g+D)$. The interval has length $L = g|D-\delta|/\{(g+D)(g+\delta)\}$. With density at most M, $\int_I (g+D)|p - D/(g+D)|\,dF \le M(g+D)\int_0^L u\,du = M(g+D)L^2/2 = Mg^2(D-\delta)^2/\{2(g+D)(g+\delta)^2\}$.

(iii, crude form) Since $g + D \ge g$ and $(g+\delta)^2 \ge 4g\delta$, $g^2/\{(g+D)(g+\delta)^2\} \le 1/(4\delta)$, so the regret is at most $(M/8\delta)\sum_t \mathbb{E}^\delta[(\Delta_{t-1}(c_t) - \delta)^2; c_t \ge 1]$. □

Envelope. The unit-density integral underlying bound (ii), $r(\delta) = g^2(D-\delta)^2/\{2(g+D)(g+\delta)^2\}$ (the integral of the Q-gap over I_t against dp), has $r(D) = r'(D) = 0$ and $r''(D) = g^2/(g+D)^3$. It is not the per-state regret of a general law of p (with $g = D = 1$, $\delta = 2$ and density $2p$ the regret is $11/324$, $r = 1/36$; wolfram/regret.wl), but it bounds that regret by $M\,r(\delta)$: under a bounded density, mis-setting the constant costs nothing to first order, so the loss of the best constant is at most quadratic in the spread of Δ along the path. Where the best δ sits depends on the density near each cutoff and on how the occupation of states moves with δ; it is near a weighted mean of Δ only when those weights are roughly constant. For a law with atoms, (ii) with a histogram height in place of M is an approximation, not a bound (Section S5.7).

Stylised illustration [NUMERICAL]. In a stylised game with 60 opportunities, two challenges, stakes rising through the game and a mostly low posterior (p density $0.9\,\mathrm{Beta}(1,4) + 0.1\,\mathrm{Beta}(4,1)$), Δ ranges over $[0, 0.065]$ along the path. The best constant $\delta = 0.0245$ loses 7.6% of the optimum; identity (i) holds to 4×10^{-17}; bound (ii) gives 15.3% and the crude form (iii) 185%, so (ii) is the form to use. The loss curve is flat near its minimum: 35 % at $\delta = 0.01$, 9 % at $\delta = 0.02$, 9 % at $\delta = 0.03$, 23 % at $\delta = 0.05$. The theorem on the calibrated 2026 pools is in Section S5.7.

S1.5. *Retention against consumable challenges.* Three allotment rules: *retention* (MLB ABS, a success keeps the challenge); *consumption* (every challenge is spent); and the *NBA cap* (one challenge; a success earns a second, consumable one, so at most two are used). Let $s = \operatorname{ess\,sup}(pg)$.

THEOREM S4 (PROVED). *Under Assumption 1: (a)* $V_t^{\mathrm{cons}}(c) \le V_t^{\mathrm{ret}}(c)$ *and*

$$V_t^{\mathrm{cons}}(1) \le V_t^{\mathrm{NBA}} \le \min\{V_t^{\mathrm{ret}}(1), V_t^{\mathrm{cons}}(2)\};$$

(b) $V_t^{\mathrm{cons}}(c) \le cs$ *and* $V_t^{\mathrm{NBA}} \le 2s$ *for all* t*; (c) if* $F_t = F$ *and there is* $g_0 > 0$ *with* $\mathbb{P}(p > 1-\varepsilon,\, g > g_0) > 0$ *for every* $\varepsilon > 0$*, then* $V_t^{\mathrm{ret}}(1) \to \infty$*, and under the conditions of Theorem S2,* $V_t^{\mathrm{ret}}(1) \sim \sqrt{\mathbb{E}[h(g)g^2]\,t}$*. Hence, if moreover* $s < \infty$ *(as for bounded WP stakes), one retained challenge eventually beats any fixed allotment of consumable ones. The condition cannot be dropped: with* $p = 1/2$ *and* g *Pareto with shape* $3/2$*, a single consumable challenge already gains at least a quarter of the expected largest of* t *stakes, which grows like* $\Gamma(1/3)\,t^{2/3}$*, faster than* $\sqrt{t}$ *(`wolfram/rules_scope.wl`).*

PROOF. (a) By coupling. Run both rules on the same sequence of (p, g) and the same success events. The player under the richer rule copies the poorer player's actions and, wherever the poorer rule has removed a challenge that the richer rule keeps, stops challenging. This is feasible because on every path the richer rule holds at least as many challenges. NBA against consumption with one: after the single use consumption holds none. Retention with one against NBA: after a success both hold one, after a failure both hold none, and once NBA's consumable second challenge is spent retention may still hold one. Consumption with two against NBA: after a success both hold one; after a failure NBA holds none and consumption one. Retention against consumption with the same c: retention never holds fewer. Along coupled paths the gains are identical, so the richer rule's optimal value is at least the poorer one's. (b) At most c (respectively two) challenges are used, and each use has conditional expected gain $pg \le s$. (c) Fix $L \ge 0$ and let $\varepsilon = g_0/\{2(g_0 + L)\}$. On $\{q \le \varepsilon,\ g > g_0\}$, with $q = 1-p$, $pg - (1-p)L = g - q(g+L) \ge g(1-\varepsilon) - \varepsilon L \ge g_0 - \varepsilon(g_0 + L) = g_0/2$, so $\varphi(L) \ge (g_0/2)\mathbb{P}(p \ge 1-\varepsilon,\, g > g_0) > 0$. Step 1 of the proof of Theorem S2 then applies, and the rate is that theorem. With (b), $V_t^{\mathrm{ret}}(1) > cs \ge V_t^{\mathrm{cons}}(c)$ for all large t when $s < \infty$. The stake bound g_0 cannot be dropped: with $q = g = U \sim \mathrm{Unif}(0,1)$, $\mathbb{P}(p > 1-\varepsilon,\, g > 0) = \varepsilon > 0$ for every ε, but $\varphi(L) = \mathbb{E}\{U(1-U-L)^+\} = (1-L)^3/6$ vanishes for $L \ge 1$, so $\Delta_t(1) < 1$ for all t ($\Delta_{2000}(1) = 0.961$). □

TABLE S1
Values under the three allotment rules, uniform p *and* $g = 1$ *(*$s = 1$*), exact DP. The ordering of Theorem S4(a) holds at every* t *computed.*

t	consumption, 1	NBA cap	retention, 1	consumption, 2	retention, 2
1	0.50	0.50	0.50	0.50	0.50
2	0.62	0.83	0.83	1.00	1.00
5	0.78	1.26	1.56	1.41	2.15
10	0.86	1.52	2.42	1.64	3.54
50	0.96	1.87	6.22	1.91	9.68
100	0.98	1.93	9.11	1.95	14.36
1,000	1.00	1.99	30.67	1.99	49.24
10,000	1.00	2.00	99.02	2.00	159.83

Table S1 gives the values in the uniform case: one retained challenge beats 2, 3 and 5 consumable ones for all $t \ge 4$, 10 and 27 respectively. In the stylised game above (60 opportunities, WP per team-game) the values are 0.032 (consumption, one), 0.048 (NBA cap), 0.055 (consumption, two), 0.066 (retention, one) and 0.098 (retention, two): two retained challenges are worth 77% more than two consumable ones, and a single retained challenge already beats two consumable ones.

TABLE S2
Status of the theoretical statements.

Statement	Status
Lemma S1; Theorem 2 (any exogenous, time-varying law)	proved
Failure for c-dependent laws; top-up row of the calibrated DP (Remark S1)	counterexample; numerical
Theorem S2, with its exact constant	proved
Rate $t^{1/(1+\alpha)}$ for $\alpha \neq 1$ (Remark S2)	proved, sketch; constants exact
Time-varying laws, $\Delta_t^2 \sim \sum_s 2K_s$	proved, sketch
$c \geq 2$: $k_c^2 + k_c/k_{c-1} = 1$, $k_2 = (\sqrt{5}-1)/2$ (Remark S4)	heuristic; constants exact
Consumption bound $\Delta^{\text{cons}} \leq s$	proved
$\sqrt{n}$ scaling of the calibrated, score-averaged continuation value	numerical
Theorem S3: identity (atoms included), bound and envelope	proved
Loss of the one-line rule on the calibrated pools and on the real stream (Section S5.7)	numerical
Theorem S4; crossover points	proved; numerical

S2. Symbolic verification. The exact algebra of the paper is checked in Mathematica (Section 12). All checks are deterministic: they use exact rationals, closed forms, `Reduce`/`Resolve` over the reals, or numerical integration at 30 digits, never sampling. The scripts:

- wolfram/check.wl → results/check.json: the retained-challenge cutoff and its monotonicity, and the Gaussian convolution used when tracking noise is added to decision noise.
- wolfram/identification_det.wl → results/identification-det-check.json: Proposition 1, identification of the deterministic-truth model (checks D1–D4).
- wolfram/identification.wl → results/identification-check.json: the alternative smooth-truth model, in which only the combined scale of tracking and decision noise enters the challenge curve. It is kept because it shows why a known truth matters (Section 3).
- wolfram/proofs.wl → results/proofs.json: the theory of Section S1 (T1–T4), including every numerical value quoted there.
- wolfram/supplement.wl → results/supplement-check.json: the algebraic steps added in this supplement (substitution and domination in the proof of Theorem S2, bound (ii), the mean-value step).
- wolfram/headline.wl → results/headline-check.json: the per-state regret, the causal decomposition of Section S5.3 and the cutoff form of the competitor rules.
- wolfram/drs_check.wl and wolfram/drs_audit.wl → results/drs/: the closed forms of the DRS model (Section S7).
- wolfram/intervention.wl → results/intervention-check.json: the intervention model of Section 4 – the behavioural signal $s_p + \sqrt{1-\rho}\,\sigma_r \varepsilon_2$ has noise exactly $N(0, \sigma_r^2)$ for every ρ (Proposition 1(d)), so $\partial \mathbb{P}(\text{challenge} \mid w)/\partial \rho = 0$, and the value of the calibrated one-opportunity cutoff decision falls with the signal noise on a grid of priors, stakes and continuation values.
- wolfram/honest_scoring.wl → results/honest-scoring-check.json: the selection optimism of scoring a policy at the stakes it decided on ($s\,\phi\{(c-g)/s\}$ for a Gaussian estimate, zero with an independent scoring estimate; Remark 1) and the share of distinct games in a bootstrap resample ($1-(1-1/n)^n$, 63.2% at $n = 2{,}425$, limit $1-e^{-1}$).
- Auxiliary scripts, each checking one statement where it is cited: wolfram/rules_scope.wl (the growth of a consumable challenge and the Student-t posterior), wolfram/regret.wl (the per-state regret) and wolfram/atom_endpoint.wl (the endpoint convention for atoms of the calibrated belief).

Table S3 lists the 33 checks and their outcomes; 0 fail.

TABLE S3

Symbolic checks. "True": Mathematica returned `True` *for an identity or a quantified inequality. "Max. error": the largest absolute difference between a closed form and direct high-precision integration, or between the value computed in Python and the exact one.*

Script	Claim	Outcome
`check.wl`	Cutoff: challenge iff $p \geq \Delta/(g+\Delta)$ (no counterexample)	True
`check.wl`	Cutoff increasing in Δ, decreasing in g	True
`identification_det.wl`	D1: deterministic truth is the $\sigma_m \to 0$ limit of the smooth truth model	max. error 4×10^{-8}
`identification_det.wl`	D2: two-point Jacobian determinant $\phi_1\phi_2(w_1 - w_2)/\sigma_r^3$	0 (exact)
`identification_det.wl`	D2: rank of the challenge-curve Jacobian on the data grid, batter / catcher	2 / 2
`identification_det.wl`	D3: cross information of π with (σ_r, κ)	0 (exact)
`identification_det.wl`	D4: tracking noise c gives $\Phi\{(w-\kappa)/(\sigma_r^2 + c^2)^{1/2}\}$	max. error 3×10^{-25}
`check.wl`	Gaussian convolution of tracking and perception noise (symbolic and 30-digit)	True; max. error 4×10^{-29}
`identification.wl`	I1, I3: in the smooth-truth model only $(\sigma_m^2 + \sigma_r^2)^{1/2}$ enters the challenge curve	0 (exact); rank 2 of 3
`proofs.wl`	T1a: Lemma S1 for any law (ForAll over the reals)	True
`proofs.wl`	T1b: induction step of Theorem 2	True
`proofs.wl`	T1c: both monotonicities in exact DPs on 300 random laws	True
`proofs.wl`	T1d: concavity fails for a law that depends on c	True
`proofs.wl`	T2a: $d\varphi(d) \to g^2 h/2$ and $d^\alpha \varphi(d) \to g^{1+\alpha}/(1+\alpha)$	True
`proofs.wl`	T2b: square-increment identity (S3)	0 (exact)
`proofs.wl`	T2d: exact constants $K_1 = 9/8$, $K_2 = 83/144$	True
`proofs.wl`	T2e: $k_2 = (\sqrt{5}-1)/2$; SA drift decreasing with root k_c^2	True
`proofs.wl`	T2f: consumption step $x \leq s,\ Y \leq s \Rightarrow x + \mathbb{E}(Y-x)^+ \leq s$	True
`proofs.wl`	T3a: per-state regret on both sides of D; crude bound	True
`proofs.wl`	T3b: regret identity in the stylised game	gap 4×10^{-17}
`supplement.wl`	Substitution and domination bounds in the proof of Theorem S2	True
`supplement.wl`	Bound (ii) of Theorem S3; crude bound (iii)	True
`supplement.wl`	Mean-value step for the rate $t^{1/(1+\alpha)}$	True
`supplement.wl`	Theorem S4(c): bound $\varphi(L) \geq g_0/2 \cdot \mathbb{P}(\cdot)$; counterexample without g_0	True
`headline.wl`	Per-state regret, both sides; $r'(D) = 0$	True
`headline.wl`	Causal decomposition and RB difference (Section S5.3)	True
`headline.wl`	Runs rule and one-line rule are cutoff rules in p	True
`drs_check.wl`	DRS posterior and marginal; inversion of the review rule	True
`drs_check.wl`	DRS orthant correlation; bivariate normal CDF of the code	True; max. error 1×10^{-16}
`drs_check.wl`	DRS review rule with a retained umpire's call	True
`drs_audit.wl`	DRS three-way likelihood and posterior loss probability at the Test fit	max. error 7×10^{-17}
`intervention.wl`	Behavioural noise $\sqrt{\rho}\sigma_r\varepsilon_1 + \sqrt{1-\rho}\sigma_r\varepsilon_2 \sim N(0, \sigma_r^2)$; $\partial\mathbb{P}(\text{challenge} \mid w)/\partial\rho = 0$	True
`intervention.wl`	Value of the calibrated cutoff decision falls with the signal noise (12 grid points)	True

S3. Geometry and data audit.

S3.1. *Which plane each source reports.* Statcast publishes, for every pitch, a nine-parameter constant-acceleration trajectory and a location (`plate_x`, `plate_z`). Anchoring the trajectory on the reported release point, we find the distance y^* from the tip of the plate at which the trajectory passes through the reported location. Table S4 shows that through 2025 the location is at the front of the plate ($y = 17/12$ ft) and from 2026 at its midpoint ($y = 17/24$ ft), where it agrees with the trajectory to a few thousandths of an inch. The Stats API live feed (`pitchData.coordinates.pX/pZ`) stayed at the front of the plate. Its trajectory parameters and zone lines are Statcast's (identical on 100.0% and 99.96% of challenged pitches), and on the 10,544 challenged pitches of a description-based join its height is 0.95 in (SD 0.27) above Statcast's; projected to the midpoint the difference is 0.003 in. The Savant documentation says the same of `plate_x` and `plate_z`: "Through 2025, this was front-of-plate. From 2026 on, this is middle-of-plate to align with the ABS system" (Baseball Savant, 2026b).

TABLE S4

Plane of the reported pitch location. Δz: mean (SD) of trajectory height minus reported `plate_z`, in inches, with the trajectory evaluated at the front of the plate or at its midpoint; y^*: where the trajectory meets the reported location.

Source	Pitches	Δz at front (SD)	Δz at midpoint (SD)	Median y^* (ft)
Statcast 2024 (one day)	4,386	+0.003 (0.035)	−0.972 (0.301)	1.41
Statcast 2025 (one day)	8,639	+0.003 (0.035)	−0.978 (0.307)	1.41
Statcast 2026 regular season	714,115	+0.967 (0.299)	+0.003 (0.035)	0.71
Statcast 2026 postseason	9,462	+0.943 (0.308)	+0.003 (0.035)	0.71
Stats API feed 2026, challenged	10,544	—	—	1.42

S3.2. *Reproduction of the ABS rulings.* The ABS zone is a rectangle as wide as the plate (17 in) whose bottom and top are 27% and 53.5% of the batter's certified height, evaluated at the plate's midpoint; a pitch is a strike if any part of the ball (radius 1.45 in) touches it. The ball is round, so the strike region is the rectangle grown by the radius with rounded corners: the signed distance is the radius plus the signed distance of the ball's centre to the rectangle. Growing each edge by the radius with square corners instead counts a ball diagonally off a corner as touching it; it relabels 353 called pitches (26 of them challenged) and reproduces 99.71% of the rulings (31 mismatches). On the current count-joined frame, where all 10,557 challenges are located, the rule on Statcast's 2026 coordinates as published reproduces 99.95% of the rulings (5 mismatches; `src/geometry_current.py`). The comparisons of geometries in Table S5 and below are on the earlier description-joined frame of 10,544 located challenges, which also carries the raw and projected coordinates side by side; there the rule reproduces the same share, and the best constant shift of either zone line is 0.00 in. Projecting the same coordinates from the front to the midpoint a second time lowers every pitch by about 0.95 in, reproduces only 84.8% of the rulings, and makes the best-fitting zone lines sit −1.00 in (bottom) and −0.75 in (top) away from the rule: a double projection of this kind produces an apparent offset between the ABS and Statcast zones. A sweep over the ball radius gives 121, 51, 5, 61, 130 mismatches at 1.40, 1.43, 1.45, 1.47 and 1.50 in, sharply minimised at the official 1.45 in (`results/geometry_audit.md`).

Table S6 breaks the reproduction down by edge, batter side, challenger and month. It is uniform: no edge, side, role or month stands out, and there is no drift over the season. The double projection, by contrast, hurt the bottom edge most, where a one-inch vertical

TABLE S5
Share of the 10,544 challenge rulings of a description-based join reproduced by the published zone rule, by geometry.

Coordinates	Rulings reproduced (%)	Mismatches
Statcast 2026 as published, ball radius included	99.95	5
Statcast as published, no ball radius	65.66	3,621
Statcast projected to the midpoint a second time	84.83	1,599
Projected a second time, no ball radius	62.54	3,950
Stats API feed as published (front of plate)	85.00	1,582
Stats API feed projected to the midpoint	99.97	3

shift matters most. The same rule reproduces the rulings in every other feed we use once its front-of-plate coordinates are projected to the midpoint (Table S7), and on the postseason's Statcast coordinates as published it reproduces 100%. The Triple-A and spring-training fits of Section S4.3 therefore use projected feed coordinates, which is correct for those feeds.

TABLE S6
Reproduction of the rulings by group, Statcast 2026 coordinates as published and projected a second time.

		Challenges	As published (%)	Mismatches	Projected twice (%)
Edge	Bottom	3,616	99.89	4	74.8
	Top	1,764	100.00	0	85.6
	Inside (batter's side)	1,844	99.95	1	91.7
	Outside	3,320	100.00	0	91.5
	Pitcher's arm side	2,708	99.96	1	89.7
	Pitcher's glove side	2,456	100.00	0	93.7
Batter	Left-handed	5,203	99.96	2	85.9
	Right-handed	5,341	99.94	3	83.8
Challenger	Batter	4,759	99.94	3	86.2
	Catcher	5,606	99.96	2	83.7
	Pitcher	179	100.00	0	86.0
Month	2026-03	286	100.00	0	86.7
	2026-04	1,640	100.00	0	85.1
	2026-05	1,699	99.94	1	83.7
	2026-06	1,699	99.82	3	84.9
	2026-07	1,643	100.00	0	85.5
	2026-08	1,920	100.00	0	85.3
	2026-09	1,657	99.94	1	84.2

TABLE S7
Reproduction in the Stats API feeds, whose coordinates are at the front of the plate.

Feed sample	Challenges	Front of plate (%)	Projected to midpoint (%)
MLB 2026 regular season	10,557	85.0	99.97
Triple-A 2025	9,341	85.7	99.95
Spring training 2026	1,907	85.3	100.00
MLB 2026 postseason	156	83.3	100.00

Zone lines and height. Statcast's 2026 `sz_top` and `sz_bot` are exactly 53.5% and 27% of a single height on every pitch. Against the whole-inch listed heights of the 662 batters, the lines differ by 0.001 in (SD 0.155) at the top and 0.001 in (SD 0.078) at the bottom; 94.4% of batters are within 0.25 in on both, and the largest difference, 0.267 in, is 0.535×0.5 in: the certified height is measured more finely than the listed one. None of the mismatches below involves a batter whose zone differs from his season median.

S3.3. *The 5 mismatches.* We re-read the live feed (pitch and play description, review flag, challenger, timing) for every mismatch.

- *Boundary ties* (3): Statcast and the feed agree and the pitch is within 0.01 in of the boundary; of these, 1 lie just inside by the rule and were ruled balls and 2 just outside and were ruled strikes. Within 0.5 in of the boundary 0.15% of the 2,698 challenged pitches mismatch; beyond 1 in, 0.02%. With round corners the mismatch rate no longer rises towards the boundary, and the ties show no lean towards either call.
- *Tracking disagreements* (1): Statcast's location differs from the live feed's by inches, and the feed's location agrees with the ruling. Among the 4 challenged pitches where the two sources disagree by more than 0.5 in, the feed is right and Statcast wrong in 1 case(s) and Statcast right and the feed wrong in 0. The join of the two sources uses the pre-pitch count, not the ruling (Section S3.4).
- *Other* (1): a boundary tie in Statcast that the feed places outside the zone.
- *Mislabels*: none. Every recorded call and review flag agrees with the play-by-play text.

The mismatches are spread over the season and over batter and catcher challenges. They are what the mislabel rate $\pi = 0.05\%$ of model (1) absorbs.

S3.4. *Challenges left and the feed's counters.* We reconstruct the challenges each team holds before every pitch: two at the start, one fewer after each failed challenge, plus the extra-inning rule below. The live feed reports, per team and game, the numbers of successful and failed challenges and the challenges remaining (`src/feed_counters.py`, `results/feed_counters.json`). Over the 4,850 team-games of the 2,425 ABS games our counts of successes and failures equal the feed's in 4,849. The exception is game 822717, where one ABS challenge is nested inside a manager's review of the same play and its pitch is ambiguous; we leave it out. The feed's "remaining" equals $\max(0, 2 - \text{failed})$ in 100% of team-games, so it ignores the extra-inning grants; yet teams fail up to 4 times in a game, which is only possible with grants. Our end-of-game count differs from the feed's in 113 team-games, and every one of these received an extra-inning grant (0 without one). No challenge in the data is made with none left (0 cases).

Sample flow. Table S8 follows the called pitches from the feeds to the likelihood and to the policies' opportunity set. A called pitch is joined to the Statcast pitch of the same plate appearance with the same pre-pitch count and call type (the feed's pre-pitch count is its post-pitch count minus the call; Statcast reports the final call, so overturned pitches agree). Within a plate appearance the count only rises, so the key is unique. A join on the pitch number, screened by agreement of the descriptions, kept 94 called pitches whose two sources disagree on the count: when one source counts an automatic ball or strike as a pitch and the other does not, the numbers shift, and two successive balls (or strikes) pass the description screen with another pitch's location. Under the count join 449 called pitches carry different numbers in the two sources (their Statcast location agrees with the feed's own within 0.013 in) and 3 find no count-consistent Statcast pitch and are unlocated (`results/join_audit.json`). A position player pitching is a pitcher with at least 30 plate appearances and fewer than 400 pitches in 2026; MLB's opportunity definition excludes such pitches. Technical unavailability of the system is not flagged in the public data and is not excluded.

TABLE S8
Sample flow, 2026 regular season (2,425 ABS games).

Step	Called pitches	Challenges
Called pitches in the feeds	370,963	10,557
without a Statcast location	−201	0
mis-joined to another Statcast pitch	0	0
Located called pitches	370,762	10,557
thrown by position players (not opportunities)	−1,143	0
Policies' opportunity set	369,619	
Likelihood sample, batters (challenge held, $\lvert w\rvert < 8$ in)	100,714	4,766
Likelihood sample, fielding side	141,199	5,791

The extra-inning rule. MLB's announcement of the challenge system (Major League Baseball, 2025) gives a team that has used up its challenges one challenge in each extra inning; unused extra-inning challenges do not accumulate. We apply it as: a team at zero receives one challenge at the start of each extra inning, with no stacking. Over the 285 extra innings of the season this grants 151 challenges in 145 team-games, and 210 challenges are made in extra innings. The grant enters the DP and the simulator at the first opportunity of every extra inning, in either half.

Other data notes. Under the count join every one of the 10,557 challenges has a Statcast location. The likelihood uses called pitches within 8 in of the zone edge; the policies see every located opportunity. 0 located challenges lie farther out than 8 in. The DP's law of the number of opportunities in a half-inning counts every Statcast half-inning of the season's games, including the 188 of the 43,132 with no opportunity for either side, also inside every bootstrap resample.

S4. The decision model.

S4.1. *Specification and estimates.* The criterion is $\kappa(x) = x^\top \beta$ with an intercept, $\log g$, an indicator of one challenge left, the inning divided by nine (capped at ten), and indicators of two strikes and of three balls, separately for batters (on called strikes) and catchers and pitchers (on called balls). In the main specification κ shifts by zone region (bottom, top, inside, outside) and σ_r is multiplied by a region factor, with the bottom edge as reference. The truth is deterministic with mislabel rate π, shared by the two sides. The likelihood (2) is maximised by L-BFGS followed by a Newton trust region with the exact Hessian from automatic differentiation. Table S9 gives the estimates of the comparator and of the model with player random effects.

S4.2. *All variants.* Table S10 extends Table 1 with the mislabel rate, BIC relative to the comparator, and the wins lost under a score-free DP (no score in the state) next to the score-aware DP of the headline; every row is evaluated with all policies on the same $R = 20$ simulated draws. The smooth-truth rows add, per edge or region, an offset and Gaussian measurement noise to the truth; they are not preferred to the deterministic model by BIC (Section 3.1). Without a mislabel rate ("by edge, no mislabel") the measurement noise inflates to absorb the few tracking disagreements of Section S3.3, and the fit is far worse. Heavy-tailed and logistic noise are rejected at equal parameter count. Among the homogeneous probit models that fit at least as well as the Gaussian baseline, wins lost range over 0.61–0.73; the rejected noise laws on the comparator give 0.88–1.22. Across the models whose BIC is at least as good as the comparator's (lapse and player-effects models included, every lapse kept) they range over 0.49–0.69.

TABLE S9

Estimates of the main decision model and of the primary model with player random effects $(\kappa_i, \log \sigma_{r,i})$ and a lapse rate, the effects bivariate normal per side and integrated by Gauss–Hermite quadrature with 11×11 nodes (against 5×5 the log-likelihood improves by 4.0, σ_r moves by at most 2.5% and the SD of the batters' criterion from 1.19 to 1.24 in). Distances in inches.

	Comparator		Player effects + lapse	
Parameter	batter	catcher	batter	catcher
κ: intercept	4.64	2.70	4.41	2.45
κ: $\log g$	0.00	0.01	−0.01	0.01
κ: one challenge left	0.46	0.62	0.50	0.68
κ: inning/9	−2.13	−1.69	−2.25	−1.74
κ: two strikes	−2.50	−0.72	−2.61	−0.71
κ: three balls	−0.29	−0.49	−0.29	−0.50
κ: $(\log g + 5)_+$	−0.78	−0.33	−0.73	−0.33
κ: $(\log g + 4)_+$	0.26	0.13	0.20	0.13
κ: $(\log g + 3.2)_+$	−0.12	−0.43	−0.12	−0.43
κ shift, top edge (in)	1.33	0.75	1.25	0.69
κ shift, inside edge (in)	1.03	0.24	1.03	0.24
κ shift, outside edge (in)	1.01	0.08	0.94	0.09
σ_r, bottom edge (in)	2.88	1.82	2.62	1.68
σ_r multiplier, top edge	1.04	1.27	1.03	1.29
σ_r multiplier, inside edge	1.11	1.01	1.14	1.01
σ_r multiplier, outside edge	1.03	0.91	1.01	0.90
Mislabel rate π (%)	0.05		0.05	
SD of player κ_i (in)	—	—	1.24	0.43
SD of player $\log \sigma_{r,i}$	—	—	0.12	0.11
Correlation of player effects	—	—	0.61	0.41
Lapse rate λ (%)	—	—	14.2	12.3

Fit. The comparator predicts 4,760 batter challenges against 4,766 observed and 5,774 fielding-side (catcher and pitcher) challenges against 5,791, and the overturn rates of Section 3. On 22 groups of pitches the summed Pearson discrepancies of the challenge counts are 78 (batters) and 107 (catchers), and of the overturn counts among the model's challenges 57 and 21. The groups come from five overlapping partitions (distance, challenges left, inning, stake tercile, zone region), so the same pitches enter several times and the sums have no χ^2 reference distribution; they are descriptive calibration discrepancies, and with 370,762 called pitches they detect small departures from the probit shape. The random-effects model below fits better.

Nonparametric check of the probit shape. Identification rests on the shape of the challenge curve, and the comparison with logistic and t noise only shows that the Gaussian is best within a parametric family. Figure S1 drops the family. For each side and zone region it plots the isotonic regression of the challenge indicator on w (monotone under any location-family noise law) with a pointwise 95% band from a game bootstrap ($B = 200$), against the fitted probit curve averaged over the same pitches and smoothed in the same way. The largest gap between the two is 8 percentage points, and the probit curve lies inside the band at 59–100% of the grid points. The departures are local except in the upper tail, where the data are thin: 44% of the 374 batter opportunities wrong by more than 3 in are challenged (73 beyond 4 in) and 70% of the 241 catcher opportunities (47 beyond 4 in); the raw challenge rate is 41% and 68% at 3–4 in and still rising (53% and 84% at 4–5 in), and 87% of the wrong calls are within 2 in of the edge. No plateau is observed; a lapse rate is identified by the curvature of the response over $w \in (0, 4]$ jointly with σ_r and κ, that is, by the Gaussian shape. The far

TABLE S10

All decision-model and truth variants. $\Delta\ell$: log-likelihood relative to the Gaussian baseline; ΔBIC: relative to the comparator (negative is better); wins lost per team-season under the score-aware and the pooled DP, at the full-season stakes, not cross-fitted, with every lapse kept ($\ell = 0$) in the lapse models (full policy cross-fit values are in Table 1).

Model	k	$\Delta\ell$	ΔBIC	π (%)	σ_r (in)		Wins lost	
					batter	catcher	score DP	score-free DP
Smooth truth by edge, no mislabel	18	−193.3	+910	—	3.04	1.87	0.64	0.53
Smooth truth by region + mislabel	23	+20.8	+544	0.02	3.04	1.87	0.65	0.55
Baseline: deterministic truth + mislabel	15	+0.0	+486	0.05	3.04	1.87	0.64	0.54
Logistic ε	15	−154.9	+796	0.05	2.75	1.74	0.90	0.78
t_{10} ε	15	−107.2	+701	0.05	2.82	1.76	0.84	0.72
t_5 ε	15	−359.0	+1204	0.05	2.74	1.73	0.99	0.87
t_3 ε	15	−854.0	+2195	0.05	2.97	1.88	1.19	1.07
σ_r by edge	17	+62.9	+385	0.05	3.16	1.97	0.65	0.54
σ_r by region	21	+172.4	+216	0.05	3.39	1.94	0.69	0.58
σ_r linear in $\lvert w\rvert$	17	+6.4	+499	0.05	3.21	1.88	0.61	0.51
σ_r by region + slope	23	+182.6	+220	0.05	3.64	1.97	0.63	0.53
κ by region	21	+193.6	+174	0.05	2.98	1.87	0.66	0.56
κ and σ_r by region, κ linear in $\log g$	27	+263.3	+109	0.05	2.88	1.82	0.69	0.57
Same + σ_r slope	29	+270.6	+119	0.05	3.05	1.85	0.64	0.54
Same + lapse rate	29	+276.8	+106	0.05	2.69	1.70	0.49	0.38
Same, κ piecewise linear in $\log g$ (comparator)	33	+354.8	+0	0.05	2.88	1.82	0.69	0.58
Comparator + low-stake hinge in κ	35	+355.6	+23	0.05	2.88	1.82	0.69	0.58
Comparator + σ_r varying with $\log g$	35	+359.7	+15	0.05	2.89	1.82	0.73	0.63
Comparator, logistic ε	33	+177.9	+354	0.05	2.71	1.72	0.95	0.83
Comparator, t_{10} ε	33	+228.9	+252	0.05	2.76	1.74	0.88	0.76
Comparator, t_5 ε	33	−33.9	+777	0.05	2.75	1.73	1.02	0.91
Comparator, t_3 ε	33	−538.1	+1786	0.05	3.08	1.90	1.22	1.10
Comparator + lapse rate	35	+369.7	−5	0.05	2.68	1.69	0.49	—
Comparator, second-half shifts in κ, σ_r	39	+397.8	−12	0.05	2.94	1.87	—	—
Same + lapse rate	41	+411.2	−14	0.05	2.74	1.77	—	—
Comparator + player effects (5×5 nodes)	39	+1032.0	−1280	0.05	2.84	1.82	0.76	0.66
Comparator + player effects (11×11)	39	+1033.7	−1283	0.05	2.81	1.81	—	—
Comparator + player effects + lapse (5×5)	41	+1047.7	−1287	0.05	2.69	1.70	0.60	0.50
Comparator + player effects + lapse (11×11, primary)	41	+1051.7	−1295	0.05	2.62	1.68	—	—
Comparator + game-state terms in κ	43	+526.7	−220	0.05	2.87	1.80	—	—
Primary + game-state terms in κ	51	+1229.8	−1527	0.05	2.62	1.63	—	—

misses that are not challenged are not independent of the state, as an attention lapse would be: in a logit on the state, the batters' challenge probability rises with $\log g$ (0.34, SE 0.13) and falls with one challenge left (-0.74, SE 0.26; catchers -0.92, SE 0.35), so part of the "lapse" is a choice about stakes and inventory, which is one reason the removable share ℓ is a sensitivity parameter (Section 8). The lapse-rate model of Table S10, $\mathbb{P}(\text{challenge} \mid w) = (1-\lambda)\Phi\{(w-\kappa)/\sigma_r\}$ with one λ per side, fits better by 15 log-likelihood points (2 parameters), gives $\lambda = 15\%$ for batters and 12% for catchers and σ_r of 2.68 and 1.69 in, and gives wins lost of 0.85 with the lapses removed and 0.49 with them kept ($R = 20$, full-sample evaluation). Without the join check of Section 2 the apparent levelling-off, and with it the lapse model's advantage, would be much larger: mis-joined pitches carry another pitch's location, which mostly reads as a badly missed call that nobody challenged.

Player heterogeneity. Player random effects on $(\kappa, \log\sigma_r)$ improve the likelihood by 679 points over the comparator, and with a lapse rate on top they have the best BIC among the models without game-state terms (54,035). The effects sit mostly in the criterion: the SD of the player criteria is 1.24 in for batters and 0.43 in for catchers, against an SD of $\log\sigma_r$ of 0.12 and 0.11. Both random-effects fits are refined by Newton steps on a central-difference Hessian of the exact likelihood gradient after L-BFGS, to a maximum gradient of 3×10^{-8} with the lapse and 9×10^{-4} without it (quasi-Newton iterations alone stop at gradients of 0.1–1.3). To evaluate policies each player's criterion and noise effects are drawn *jointly* from a bivariate normal with the posterior means and covariance computed on the quadrature nodes (posterior correlation about 0.6 on average; a moment-matched approximation, not a draw from the node weights), the belief is calibrated within the player's noise quintile, and the DP

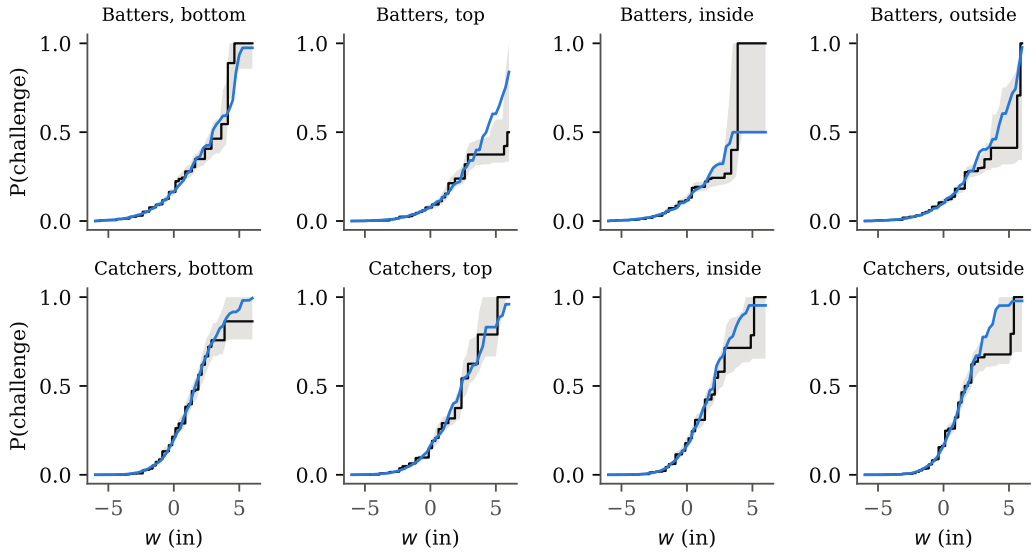


FIG S1. *Challenge probability against the truth margin w (inches, positive: the call was wrong), by side and zone region. Black: isotonic regression of the observed challenges with pointwise 95% game-bootstrap band (grey). Blue: fitted comparator (probit), averaged over the same pitches.*

is solved with these posteriors. In the full policy cross-fit the posteriors are those of each training fit, with $J = 4$ joint draws per fold (Section S5.10). The primary estimate and its interval are in Section 7 and Section S5.11. Integrated over the fitted population law the primary model predicts 4,622 batter challenges and 5,843 fielding-side challenges against 4,766 and 5,791 observed, and with each player's posterior mean plugged in 4,588 and 5,743; the homogeneous comparator predicts 4,760 and 5,774. The batters' shortfall of about 3% under the Gaussian law of the player effects (a fifth of the batters never challenged) is a misfit of that law, which the primary model's policy values inherit.

A time-varying criterion. Adding second-half (July–September) shifts to the criterion's intercept and its slope on $\log g$ and to $\log \sigma_r$, for each side, improves the comparator's BIC by 12 (14 with a lapse rate as well); the fielding side's criterion falls and its noise drops in the second half, as the out-of-sample comparison below shows. Its gap under the primary intervention is 0.64 (full policy cross-fit, Table 1).

S4.3. *Out of sample and other leagues.* We fit the model to March–June (1,279 games) and to July–September (1,146 games) separately. Decision noise is 2.88 in for batters and 1.92 in for catchers in the first half and 2.87 and 1.71 in in the second. Table S11 predicts the challenge counts and overturn rates of the second half from the first-half fit. Overturn rates transfer for both sides and batter challenge counts nearly so, but catchers challenged 22% more than predicted, and their fitted decision noise fell: the fielding side's decisions changed during the season. Wins lost under the comparator and the score-aware DP, each half against its own benchmark, are 0.71 in the first half, 0.54 in the second half with the first-half model and 0.65 with the second-half model.

For Triple-A 2025 and spring training 2026 we use the Stats API feeds, projected to the plate's midpoint (Table S7). The refitted decision noise is 3.22 in [3.07, 3.37] for batters and 2.09 in [2.01, 2.18] for catchers in Triple-A, and 3.78 in [3.39, 4.21] and 2.18 in [2.00, 2.37] in spring training (95% intervals). Transported MLB parameters overpredict the overturn rates

there by several points and overpredict catcher challenges (Table S7), a criterion and noise effect.

TABLE S11
Observed against predicted challenges and overturn rates (observed / predicted). "Fit": the sample the parameters are estimated on.

	Batter		Catcher	
Sample and parameters	Challenges	Overturn (%)	Challenges	Overturn (%)
Mar–Jun, in sample	2,491 / 2,487	47.6 / 49.0	2,839 / 2,832	58.3 / 58.7
Jul–Sep, Mar–Jun fit	2,275 / 2,189	50.2 / 50.4	2,952 / 2,420	57.7 / 58.3
Jul–Sep, Jul–Sep fit	2,275 / 2,273	50.2 / 50.9	2,952 / 2,944	57.7 / 57.8
Triple-A 2025, MLB fit	4,507 / 4,432	45.0 / 50.1	4,832 / 5,444	53.8 / 58.6
Triple-A 2025, refit	4,507 / 4,498	45.0 / 46.3	4,832 / 4,817	53.8 / 54.6
Spring 2026, MLB fit	886 / 915	45.7 / 52.7	1,019 / 1,225	59.5 / 63.1
Spring 2026, refit	886 / 881	45.7 / 46.3	1,019 / 1,007	59.5 / 57.5

Feed coordinates. Rebuilding the 2026 MLB data on the live feed's own coordinates, projected to the midpoint, gives σ_r of 3.11 and 1.88 in in the baseline model and 2.90 and 1.84 in in the comparator, against 3.04 / 1.87 and 2.88 / 1.82 in on Statcast; wins lost are 0.62 and 0.64.

A frozen policy. The temporal cross-fit of the main text freezes every component estimated on March–June: the WP engine, the stakes the player decides on and the run laws (from March–June Statcast); the decision-model fit, refitted on those March–June stakes, so that no frozen component sees the full-season engine; the stake-tercile cut points of the calibration cells; the belief maps (fitted on auxiliary draws of the March–June pitches); the score-aware DP; and the constant δ. Applied to July–September, the value of a flip is scored at the full-season stakes, the yardstick of the observed value; the truths and signals there are simulated from the frozen model, so this checks that the fitted policy objects transfer over time, not observed out-of-sample welfare. Against the benchmark re-estimated on July–September on the same draws, the frozen DP keeps 99.1% and the frozen rule 94.7%; with the full-season engine instead of the March–June one the figures are 99.2% and 94.7% (wins lost against the frozen DP 0.48). If the July–September truths are drawn from the July–September fit instead, the frozen DP keeps 98.4% and teams lose 0.60 against it.

S4.4. *Identification and known-truth recovery.* Proposition 1 is checked symbolically (Section S2, checks D1–D4). For the known-truth experiment we simulate challenges and rulings from the fitted baseline model ($\sigma_r = 3.04$ and 1.87 in, $\pi = 0.05\%$) on the real 2026 opportunities, refit from a start with σ_r multiplied by 1.5, and repeat. Table S12 reports the results. For the primary model (`src/recovery_primary.py`) we simulate 12 seasons from its fit, every player at his posterior mean, and refit it from its estimate: the lapse rates come back with bias +0.9 and -1.0 percentage points (SD 3.6 and 2.4), σ_r with -1.2% and +0.0%, and the SD of the batters' criterion effects -17% low, as the shrunken generating effects predict. In this baseline experiment, under correct specification, the bias in σ_r is a fraction of a percent. Tracking noise of 0.3 in barely moves σ_r, in line with Proposition 1(c), but it raises the fitted mislabel rate, which absorbs the induced disagreements near the boundary. Heavy tails fitted as Gaussian bias σ_r up by about a quarter, but among the laws we fitted the likelihood prefers the Gaussian (Table S10). Ignoring player heterogeneity (simulated

with the SDs of an earlier player-effects fit without lapses, 1.18 in in κ and 0.14 in $\log \sigma_r$ for batters) also biases σ_r up, which lowers the estimated value of challenging. On the data the bias is smaller: the comparator's batter σ_r is 2.4% above the random-effects model's. The direct comparison is the accounting index: 0.51 under the primary model against 0.63 under the homogeneous comparator (full policy cross-fit).

TABLE S12
Known-truth recovery of decision noise on the real 2026 opportunities.

Data-generating process	Converged	Bias of $\hat{\sigma}_r$ (%)		SD of $\hat{\sigma}_r$ (in)		Mean $\hat{\pi}$ (%)
		batter	catcher	batter	catcher	
Correctly specified	18/20	+0.4	+0.4	0.04	0.02	0.06
0.3 in tracking noise	10/10	+0.1	+1.0	0.05	0.02	6.14
t_5 perception noise	10/10	+24.8	+22.6	0.06	0.02	0.04
Player random effects	10/10	+11.8	+4.2	0.07	0.02	0.04

S4.5. *Wins lost against decision noise.* The value of every policy falls as the decision noise grows, the benchmark's fastest. Figure S2 and Table S13 re-solve and re-evaluate the model with σ_r multiplied by a common factor on both sides, holding realised play fixed at 3.34 wins per team-season. Wins lost fall to 0.25 when σ_r is 20% larger than estimated (by linear interpolation) and to zero near a factor of 1.3. The right panel is the profile log-likelihood of each side's σ_r in the baseline model on the same axis: at the break-even it is 73 points below its maximum for batters and 133 for catchers, and a 10% error already costs 21 and 38.

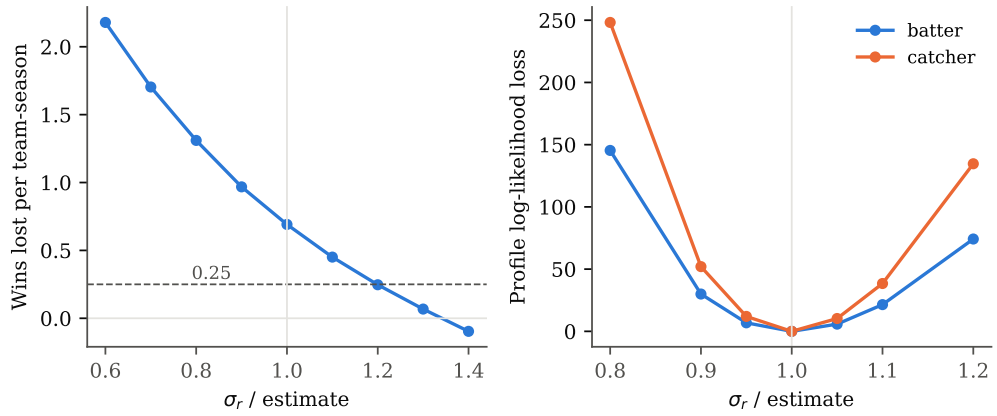


FIG S2. *Left: wins lost per team-season (score-aware benchmark minus realised play) when decision noise is a multiple of its estimate; dashed line at* 0.25. *Right: profile log-likelihood loss of σ_r for each side, baseline model.*

Belief maps. Under the calibrated posterior the challenge threshold implied by the fitted criterion is on average $p = 0.34$ for batters and 0.33 for catchers; under a flat-prior belief map it would be 0.89 and 0.81. Neither map makes the implied thresholds respond to leverage as the cutoff (3) requires (Section 9).

TABLE S13

Benchmark and wins lost per team-season when σ_r is a multiple of its estimate, and the profile log-likelihood loss at the multiples on the profile grid.

σ_r / estimate	Benchmark	Wins lost		Profile $-\Delta\ell$ (baseline model)	
		score DP	score-free DP	batter	catcher
0.6	5.52	+2.18	+2.05	—	—
0.7	5.05	+1.70	+1.58	—	—
0.8	4.66	+1.31	+1.19	145.4	248.2
0.9	4.31	+0.97	+0.86	30.0	52.0
1.0	4.04	+0.69	+0.57	0.0	0.0
1.1	3.80	+0.45	+0.33	21.5	38.4
1.2	3.59	+0.25	+0.12	74.2	134.7
1.3	3.41	+0.07	−0.04	—	—
1.4	3.25	−0.10	−0.21	—	—

S5. Policy evaluation.

S5.1. *Simulated worlds.* Each simulated world keeps every real 2026 called pitch, its stake g, its known truth W and the real call stream. It draws the ruling with mislabel rate π, the signal $s = w + \varepsilon$ from the fitted decision model, and the posterior $p = \mathbb{P}(Y = 1 \mid s)$ that the ruling overturns the call from a weighted isotonic regression of simulated truth on the signal (Barlow et al., 1972). Under Gaussian noise the posterior is monotone in the signal; under Student-t noise it need not be (with prior mass $\frac{1}{2}$ at $w = \pm 1$ and t_3 noise it is $\frac{1}{2}$, $\frac{9}{10}$ and $\frac{961}{1402}$ at signals 0, 2 and 10, tending to $\frac{1}{2}$; `wolfram/rules_scope.wl`), so for the t rows the isotonic map is a monotone approximation to their posterior, not the posterior itself. The isotonic map is fitted on an auxiliary, independent draw, so that the truth that scores a policy never enters its decision. Fitting it on the scoring draw instead changed the benchmark by -0.006 and the one-line rule by -0.017 wins per team-season (average over $R = 6$ draws). Every policy runs on the same draws, holding the challenges it would hold, with the extra-inning grant of Section S3.4. Table S14 splits the value of every policy by side.

TABLE S14

Wins per team-season by side and challenges per team-game (95% game-bootstrap interval); the comparator with the stakes cross-fitted only (Table S15).

Policy	Wins, batters	Wins, fielding side	Challenges per team-game
Benchmark	1.82	2.17	2.70 [2.66, 2.74]
Runs-objective rule	1.78	2.14	2.98 [2.93, 3.01]
Score-free DP	1.77	2.11	2.68 [2.63, 2.72]
One-line rule, $\delta = 0.008$	1.72	2.09	2.22 [2.15, 2.29]
One-line rule, $\delta = 0.01$	1.65	2.06	1.90 [1.84, 1.97]
48-cell card, published	1.68	2.08	2.59 [2.53, 2.64]
48-cell card, refit	1.66	2.06	2.51 [2.46, 2.55]
Observed 2026 (realised)	1.44	1.90	2.18 [2.14, 2.22]
Fitted behavioural rule	1.43	1.88	2.16 [2.12, 2.20]
Fixed 0.2-run rule	0.95	1.50	1.03 [0.98, 1.10]

S5.2. *Competitor rules.* *Runs-objective rule* (Namuduri, 2026): challenge iff $p\,\mathrm{RV} > (1 - p)C(t, c)$, where RV is the run value of the flip and C the run value of a challenge

at the start of the half-inning, from the same DP solved with runs as the objective. His code indexes C by incorrect challenges spent, which maps to our c. *48-cell card* (Arora, 2026): a threshold on p for each inning band (1–3, 4–6, 7–8, 9+), tercile of g over all opportunities, count class (PA-ending iff three balls or two strikes) and challenges held. "Published" uses his 2026 thresholds with our terciles of g; "refit" fills each cell with the median break-even $D/(g+D)$ of our DP over the opportunities in it, a reproduction of his fitting procedure on our model; a card whose cells were chosen to maximise value could do better. Our tercile medians of g are close to his. *Savant's form, tuned*: $p \geq c/(c + \mathrm{RV})$ with c on a grid of run costs, the best chosen at the point estimate (0.08 runs). *Fixed 0.2-run rule* (Baseball Savant, 2026a; Tango, 2026a): challenge iff $p \geq 0.2/(0.2 + \mathrm{RV})$. The league computes RV from an RE288 run-expectancy table; we compute it from our own run-expectancy engine, whose run swings are slightly smaller on average, so our version of the rule is marginally more conservative. The ranking does not depend on this: an independent recomputation on Statcast's own run- and win-expectancy changes gives 2.03 wins per team-season for the rule against 3.18 for observed play (ratio 0.64) and 3.71 for the one-line rule. All competitors and the one-line rule are cutoff rules in p (Section S2).

TABLE S15

The earlier estimator: the comparator with the stakes cross-fitted only (decision model, beliefs and DP fitted on all games), wins per team-season with 95% joint-bootstrap percentile intervals ($B = 395$); top, the benchmark and observed play; bottom, every public rule rebuilt on our model, with the share of the benchmark and of the gap it recovers.

Policy	Wins	Share of benchmark (%)	Challenges
Pooled-model benchmark (primary intervention)	3.99 [3.81, 4.16]	100	2.70
Score-free DP (fixed opportunity counts)	3.88 [3.70, 4.04]	97.2 [96.4, 98.0]	2.68
Clairvoyant policy (knows its game's future (p, g); not a bound)	4.80 [4.59, 5.00]	120.2 [118.5, 121.9]	3.41
Teams' fitted rule $s > \kappa(x)$ (simulated)	3.31 [3.14, 3.44]	82.9 [81.1, 84.6]	2.16
Observed 2026 (realised)	3.34 [3.16, 3.52]	83.7 [81.0, 86.8]	2.18

Rule	Share of benchmark (%)	Gap recovered (%)	Challenges
Runs-objective rule (Namuduri, 2026)	98.1 [97.3, 98.7]	88	2.98
One-line rule, $\delta = 0.008$	95.4 [94.2, 96.0]	72	2.22
One-line rule, $\delta = 0.01$	93.0 [91.9, 94.1]	57	1.90
48-cell card, median DP thresholds	93.2 [92.2, 94.5]	58	2.51
48-cell card, published (Arora, 2026)	94.3 [93.3, 95.6]	65	2.59
Fixed 0.2-run rule (Baseball Savant, 2026a)	61.4 [59.1, 64.2]	−137	1.03
Savant's form, run cost 0.08	92.1 [90.8, 93.1]	52	2.44
One-line rule at the teams' challenge rate	—	68 [61, 75]	2.18

S5.3. *Causal re-simulation.* The path-sum value of a policy is the sum of g over its successful challenges, each g read off the recorded game. After the first flip the recorded continuation is no longer the game that would have been played. For each team-game and policy we find the first divergence between the policy's game and the recorded game: the first called pitch whose call exactly one of them flips (0.76 branch points per team-game for the benchmark, 47% of them recorded overturns the policy would have skipped). Before it the two games coincide, so the path sum is exact up to there. At that pitch three worlds are simulated with common random numbers:

A: the call is flipped and the game continues, the team following the policy with the challenges it holds;
A′: the original call stands and the team keeps following the policy;
B: the original call stands and the team never challenges again.

In all three the opponent follows its fitted behavioural rule $s > \kappa(x)$ with its recorded remaining challenges. If the policy flips a call the team left standing, A is the policy's world and A′ the recorded one; if the team flipped a call the policy leaves standing, A (the flipped call) is the recorded world and A′ the policy's, and every correction below enters with the opposite sign. Up to the branch pitch the policy's game and the recorded game coincide, so their values agree up to it; this is the anchor. For a branch at which the policy flips a call the team left standing, the path-sum value of the team-game from the branch on is $g_{\text{branch}} + L_{\text{rec}}$, with L_{rec} the team's later gains on the recorded continuation, and the causal value is $g_{\text{branch}} + \mathbb{E}[L \mid \text{flip}]$. For a branch at which the team flipped a call the policy leaves standing, the path sum omits g_{branch} and still uses the recorded (flip) continuation for the policy, so the roles of A and A′ swap and the correction changes sign; the inventories in the two worlds then differ by the challenge the team kept. Two estimators of the correction:

$$\text{RB:}\quad \text{causal} = \text{path} + \mathbb{E}[(L_A - O_A) - (L_{A'} - O_{A'})],$$

$$\text{win count:}\quad \text{causal} = \text{path} + \mathbb{E}[\text{win}_A - \text{win}_{A'}] - g_{\text{branch}},$$

where L (O) sums g over the team's (the opponent's) later successful flips at the simulated state. If the WP engine is the simulator's value function, the team's win indicator is a martingale whose jump at each later flip is $+g$ for the team's flips and $-g$ for the opponent's, so $\mathbb{E}[\text{win}_A - \text{win}_{A'}] = g_{\text{branch}} + \mathbb{E}[(L_A - O_A) - (L_{A'} - O_{A'})]$ and the two estimators agree. The opponent term matters because the flip changes the opponent's later opportunities too; dropping it (the team's own gains only) changes the benchmark's RB value by 0.001 wins per team-season; RB is the low-variance version (the decomposition is checked in Section S2). Differencing against A′ cancels any level bias of the simulator's opportunity stream.

The complete contrast. Both A and A′ follow the policy after the branch, so the corrections above replace only the first divergence; later divergences between the policy and the recorded game are still valued on the recorded path. A small example shows the consequence. With one retained challenge that always succeeds, a recorded team that never challenges, and three opportunities worth 0.1, 0.2 (which ends the opportunities when taken) and 0.1, a policy that always challenges gains 0.3, the path sum credits 0.4 and the first-divergence correction also gives 0.4. The complete contrast simulates, from the first divergence, world P (the policy's call, then the policy) against world B (the team's call, then its fitted behavioural rule $s > \kappa(x)$ at the simulated state, with the challenges the team held), with the opponent's fitted rule in both and common random numbers. Before the branch the two games coincide, so the gain of the policy over the behavioural rule in a team-game is $\mathbb{E}[\text{win}_P - \text{win}_B]$, or, valued by later stakes, $\mathbb{E}[(g_{\text{b}}\mathbf{1}_P + L_P - O_P) - (g_{\text{b}}\mathbf{1}_B + L_B - O_B)]$ with $\mathbf{1}_P$ ($\mathbf{1}_B$) indicating that the policy (the team) flipped the branch call. This contrast starts from the *recorded* game (the

first divergence is against the recorded challenges, and the team holds its recorded inventory) and continues the team with its fitted rule, so its path-sum counterpart is the path sum against the observed challenges: for the benchmark it gives 0.72 [0.65, 0.79] (value) and 0.70 [0.63, 0.77] (win count) wins per team-season, against 0.69 for the path sum minus the observed value.

The paired contrast. To compare two simulated policies like with like, the teams' fitted behavioural rule is played along the stream in the same world as the policy (same truths and signals), with its own inventory, and the policy is branched against *it* at the first pitch where their flips differ (`policies.path_trace`). From there world P (the policy's call, then the policy, holding its simulated count) and world B (the rule's call, then the rule, holding the rule's simulated count) are simulated to the end of the game, the opponent following its rule from its own simulated count in both. Its path-sum counterpart is the path sum of the policy minus that of the simulated rule on the same worlds. For the benchmark: 0.71 [0.67, 0.76] valued by later stakes, 0.68 counting wins, against 0.72 by the path sum. The win-count and the stake-valued estimators differ by about 0.03 in both contrasts; part of that is the simulator's flip swing, which falls 1.2% short of g (Section S5.4), and part we cannot attribute. The behavioural rule against itself gives zero.

Simulator. Pitch events (called pitch, swinging strike or foul tip, foul, ball in play, hit by pitch, automatic ball) by count, outs and bases from 2026 Statcast; called pitches drawn from the 2026 called-pitch pool of the same count, each with its location, truth and signal; in-play outcomes (outs, bases and runs) by count, outs and bases; for a drawn called pitch the criterion and the belief are recomputed at the simulated inning, stake and challenges held (a pool row keeps only its location, truth and signal); the DP's state uses the same encoding as the DP, including extra innings; baserunning between pitches (steals, wild pitches, passed balls and pickoffs, on about 1.0% of pitches); the runner on second in extra innings; the extra-inning challenge grant; walk-off rules. We use $K = 1000$ play-outs per world and $R = 10$ independent draws of the decision signals.

Checks. In world B the simulator's win rate minus the WP engine's is between -0.015 and -0.014 across policies, with calibration slope 1.000. The offset is the team giving up its challenges while the opponent keeps its own, and it is the same at home and away. Its no-flip continuation produces about the same later value as the recorded games (1.22 against 1.21 wins per team-season for the benchmark; difference 0.01 [-0.06, 0.08]), and the A$-$A$'$ difference cancels any level gap.

TABLE S16

Path-sum and causal values, wins per team-season, with 95% intervals for the differences from 2,000 game resamples of the per-game outputs at fixed fitted parameters.

Policy	Path sum	RB	Win count	RB − path	Win count − RB
Benchmark (score-aware DP)	4.04	4.04	4.03	+0.000 [−0.002, 0.002]	−0.01 [−0.03, 0.01]
Runs-objective rule	3.95	3.95	3.94	−0.001 [−0.002, 0.001]	−0.01 [−0.03, 0.01]
Score-free DP	3.92	3.92	3.90	+0.002 [0.000, 0.004]	−0.02 [−0.04, 0.00]
One-line rule, $\delta = 0.008$	3.86	3.86	3.84	+0.002 [0.000, 0.004]	−0.02 [−0.03, 0.00]
One-line rule, $\delta = 0.01$	3.77	3.77	3.74	+0.003 [0.001, 0.005]	−0.03 [−0.04, −0.01]
48-cell card, published	3.79	3.80	3.80	+0.001 [−0.001, 0.003]	+0.01 [−0.01, 0.03]
48-cell card, refit	3.76	3.76	3.73	+0.001 [−0.001, 0.003]	−0.02 [−0.04, −0.01]
Fitted behavioural rule	3.32	3.32	3.33	−0.001 [−0.002, 0.001]	+0.01 [−0.01, 0.03]
Fixed 0.2-run rule	2.47	2.47	2.45	+0.001 [−0.001, 0.003]	−0.01 [−0.03, 0.00]

Results. Table S16: the RB causal value is within a few thousandths of a win of the path sum for every policy. The win-count estimator differs by -0.008 [-0.025, 0.009] wins for the benchmark, which puts the wins lost at 0.68 [0.57, 0.80] on that measure; averaged over the 9 policies the difference is -0.011. Section S5.4 explains the remaining difference.

S5.4. *Simulator against WP engine.* The two estimators agree exactly when the simulator's value function is the WP engine. They differ, to first order, by the sum over branch flips of the difference between the simulator's swing in win probability and the engine's g. To measure that difference without Monte Carlo error we write each simulator as an exact pitch-level Markov chain and compute its win probabilities and its g at every branch flip of the benchmark (105 per team-season, mean engine g 0.0204). The simulator itself reproduces its chain: from 400 branch states and 2,000 play-outs each, the simulated flip swing minus the chain's is -0.0004 (SE 0.0005), and the simulated home win rate minus the engine's is +0.0004.

Table S17 adds the simulator's ingredients one at a time. A simulator whose in-play outcomes ignore the count and that has no baserunning between pitches moves win probability by only 95.4% of g. That shortfall predicts a win-count minus RB difference of -0.079 wins per team-season for the benchmark; the difference measured with that simulator is 0.000 [-0.048, 0.048], smaller in size and not distinguishable from zero. Batters ahead in the count do more damage on contact, so a count-blind in-play distribution compresses the value of turning a strike into a ball, and the extra pitches a ball buys also give runners more chances to advance. With both ingredients the simulator reaches 98.8% of g; the predicted difference is -0.010, while the one measured in this decomposition run is -0.008 [-0.025, 0.009] (-0.008 in the headline run). The shortfall in g therefore explains the sign of the difference but not all of its size; the rest is a difference in win probability between the simulator and the engine that the first-order expansion does not capture, such as the simulator's level offset (world B) at the branch states. Table S18 shows that the shortfall of the simpler simulator was largest for flips early in the count.

The path sum is priced in engine g, and the engine is the object calibrated to real outcomes: its distribution of plate-appearance outcomes is the empirical one from every 2026 pitch, and it predicts game outcomes as well as Statcast's own win expectancy (Section S5.11). A residual mismatch between simulator and engine biases the win-count estimate but not the path sum or the RB estimate, which is why the headline uses the path sum.

Home field. Neither the engine nor the simulator has a home-field term, so it cannot separate them. Estimating the engine with separate plate-appearance distributions for home and away batters gives the home team a win probability of 0.527 at the first pitch, changes g at the benchmark's branch flips by about -1.0% and changes the wins lost by -0.003.

TABLE S17

Simulator against WP engine at the benchmark's branch flips: the simulator's swing in win probability as a share of the engine's g (exact chain), and the win-count minus RB difference that the mismatch predicts, wins per team-season. Each row adds one ingredient to the row above.

Simulator	g / engine g (%)	Predicted win count − RB
Events by count; in-play outcome by the plate appearance's starting outs and bases	95.4	-0.079
+ in-play outcome by count, outs and bases	—	-0.044
+ pitch events by outs and bases	—	-0.064
+ baserunning between pitches (simulator used)	98.8	-0.010
WP engine	100	0

TABLE S18
Simulator swing relative to engine g, minus one, by the count of the branch pitch (benchmark).

Count	n	g / engine $g-1$ (%)			
		first simulator	+ contact by count	+ events by outs, bases	+ baserunning
0-0	3,005	−11.0	+1.6	−0.4	+1.3
0-1	1,027	−8.6	−0.2	−0.5	+1.3
0-2	617	−1.2	−4.9	−4.7	−2.2
1-0	1,414	−9.8	−3.4	−6.5	−4.5
1-1	1,027	−8.3	+0.3	−0.4	+1.2
1-2	965	−1.9	−2.9	−3.3	−0.9
2-0	740	+4.5	+3.1	−0.7	+2.2
2-1	783	−4.5	−1.5	−1.8	+0.7
2-2	1,105	−2.5	−3.6	−3.8	−1.2
3-0	337	−1.7	−6.7	−6.8	−3.2
3-1	547	−0.9	−2.8	−3.3	+0.2
3-2	1,024	−1.2	−2.8	−3.4	−0.4

S5.5. *Behavioural rule against realised play.* The fitted behavioural rule $s > \kappa(x)$ of the comparator, simulated holding the challenges it would hold, earns 3.31 [3.14, 3.44] wins per team-season against 3.34 realised. Table S19 compares the two by stake quintile, with the model's expectation taken pitch by pitch at the challenges actually held: the expected value of the teams' challenges is 3.32 wins per team-season against 3.34 realised, and in the top fifth of stakes the teams made 25 more challenges than the model expects and gained 0.02 more wins.

With a criterion linear in $\log g$ instead, the simulated rule earned 3.20 wins and the excess in the top quintile was large: the real response to the stake is steeper at the top than a linear criterion allows. The comparator's piecewise-linear criterion (hinges at $\log g = -5.0$, -4.0 and -3.2, about the 40th, 80th and 95th percentiles) improves the log-likelihood by 92 points with 6 more parameters (BIC better by 109), raises the simulated rule to 3.32 and leaves the decision noise practically unchanged (2.88 in for batters and 1.82 in for catchers, against 2.88 and 1.82 in for the piecewise-linear criterion), so the benchmark hardly moves (4.04 against 4.02 wins on the same $R = 10$ draws). The comparison of the benchmark with realised play uses the behavioural model only through the decision noise it reveals.

TABLE S19
Observed against model-expected challenges, overturns and value by stake quintile (comparator, expectation at the challenges actually held). Value: sum of g over overturned challenges, wins per team-season.

Side	Stake quintile	Mean g	Challenges		Overturned		Value obs. − exp.
			obs.	exp.	obs.	exp.	(wins/team-season)
Batters	1	0.0015	828	820	417	441	−0.000
	2	0.0050	580	620	312	339	−0.005
	3	0.0080	598	600	316	333	−0.005
	4	0.0130	1,002	956	528	498	+0.012
	5	0.0335	1,758	1,763	755	765	−0.012
Fielding side	1	0.0015	1,010	1,023	551	589	−0.001
	2	0.0050	921	874	587	570	+0.003
	3	0.0081	862	880	559	569	−0.003
	4	0.0131	1,097	1,127	674	669	+0.003
	5	0.0361	1,901	1,870	986	967	+0.030

S5.6. *Thresholds by stake.* Table S20 gives, by stake quintile, the confidence threshold the teams' fitted criterion implies through the calibrated belief map and the DP benchmark's threshold $D/(g+D)$ at the recorded state, and the same in inches of signal: the teams' criterion κ and the signal at which the belief reaches the one-line rule's threshold $0.008/(g+0.008)$. Teams' thresholds fall far less with the stake than the benchmark's.

TABLE S20
Revealed and benchmark thresholds by stake quintile (eligible pitches, comparator, R draws of the belief map). Signal thresholds are averages over the pitches of the quintile.

Side	Stake quintile	Median g	Confidence threshold p^*		Signal threshold (in)	
			teams	DP benchmark	teams κ	one-line rule
Batters	1	0.0014	0.46	0.65	4.1	9.1
	2	0.0052	0.48	0.55	4.5	6.7
	3	0.0081	0.47	0.48	4.5	5.0
	4	0.0136	0.44	0.34	3.7	2.9
	5	0.0281	0.36	0.19	2.4	0.3
Fielding side	1	0.0013	0.45	0.65	1.8	4.9
	2	0.0051	0.50	0.55	2.1	3.0
	3	0.0082	0.50	0.47	2.1	2.1
	4	0.0138	0.44	0.34	1.7	1.2
	5	0.0300	0.35	0.19	1.1	0.0

S5.7. *The flat-optimum bound on the calibrated pools.* To evaluate Theorem S3 exactly we need a model in which its assumptions hold. We use the score-aware calibrated DP restricted to regulation: the exogenous state is the half-inning and the home score difference at its start; the number of opportunities in a half-inning follows its empirical law in that state (as in the DP) and their (g,p) are drawn i.i.d. from the 2026 pool of that state; runs between half-innings come from their empirical law; and the game ends after the top of the ninth if the home team leads and after the ninth otherwise. In this model the MDP is exact, so identity (i) must hold to rounding. Bound (ii) needs the density bound M; we estimate it as the largest histogram density of p (bin width 0.025) within quintiles of g, and the "local" approximation replaces it by the density at the midpoint of each interval. Table S21 gives the results ($R=3$ draws). Identity (i) holds to the printed precision; the best constant $\delta=0.008$ loses 6.0%; the local approximation is close (6.5%); and (ii) with the histogram heights gives 44.7%. Because the calibrated posterior is a step function of the signal (it is fitted on bins of 0.1 in), its law has atoms and no density, so that number is a smoothed approximation, not a certified bound; identity (i) needs no density. On the real game stream the same rule loses 5%. The two problems differ: in the exact model the DP is optimal by construction, while on the real stream it is optimal for the pooled law it was solved on, not for the realised sequence of calls and stakes, and the real stream includes extra innings, where the top-up rule makes the DP and the rule act alike. The rule's share is relative to the benchmark, and a richer-state policy could do better than the benchmark.

S5.8. *Stakes validation. Statcast's contrast.* Statcast's `home_win_exp` takes a single value in each of its observed pre-pitch states (inning, half, outs, bases, score, count), so it is a table, and its ball-versus-strike contrast at a state is the table's value after a ball minus its value after a strike: the next count's entry for $b<3$ and $s<2$, and for ball four and strike three the median of `home_win_exp` + `delta_home_win_exp` over the walks and strikeouts

TABLE S21

Theorem S3 on the calibrated pools, home and away sides pooled. Loss: $1 - V^{\delta}/V^{\star}$. Identity gap: largest difference between $V^{\star} - V^{\delta}$ and the sum in (i).

δ	$V^{\delta}/V^{\star}$ (%)	Loss (%)	Local approx. (%)	Bound (ii) (%)	Identity gap
0.004	80.3	19.7	15.4	49.7	0
0.005	87.3	12.7	10.7	36.4	0
0.006	91.6	8.4	7.8	32.4	0
0.007	93.6	6.4	6.5	35.7	0
0.008	94.0	6.0	6.5	44.7	0
0.009	93.3	6.7	7.5	58.1	0
0.010	91.8	8.2	9.2	75.3	0
0.012	87.8	12.2	14.1	117.4	0
0.015	80.5	19.5	22.6	194.3	0
0.020	69.1	30.9	36.4	339.5	0

observed at that state. The contrast exists for 94.5% of the called pitches; the rest are states whose after-state Statcast never visited. Its values are rounded to 0.001. Table S22 compares it with ours by decile of our stake; the correlation over all pitches is 0.978. Engines fitted on random halves of the games give contrasts that correlate at 0.975 with each other.

TABLE S22

Ball-versus-strike contrast (batting team, WP): ours against Statcast's own win expectancy, by decile of our stake g.

Leverage decile	Pitches	Mean g, ours	Mean g, Statcast	Correlation
1	35,030	0.0006	0.0007	0.174
2	35,097	0.0025	0.0026	0.400
3	34,966	0.0043	0.0044	0.350
4	35,013	0.0060	0.0062	0.229
5	35,117	0.0075	0.0079	0.217
6	34,954	0.0092	0.0095	0.306
7	35,020	0.0118	0.0122	0.285
8	35,019	0.0159	0.0159	0.398
9	35,030	0.0227	0.0224	0.547
10	35,014	0.0492	0.0485	0.963

Outcomes near the edge. For called pitches within 2 in of the ABS edge, in games not used to fit the engine, we regress $Y - \mathrm{WP}_{\mathrm{strike}}$ on $(1, \mathrm{WP}_{\mathrm{strike}}, \mathbf{1}\{\mathrm{ball}\}\, g)$ by least squares with game-clustered errors, where Y is the batting team's win and the call is the one that stood after any challenge. Within that band the ABS call turns on fractions of an inch; we assume that given the state the call is then close to randomised. Within the band the pre-pitch covariates are balanced between balls and strikes except the strike count (standardised difference 0.28; at most 0.09 for outs, runners, inning, score, side, batter's hand and $\log g$), the umpire's count-dependent zone; we have not checked pitcher, umpire or pitch characteristics. The call is the one that stood after any challenge; with the umpire's original call instead the slope is 0.84 [0.59, 1.09]. Under the assumption a correct contrast predicts a slope of one. Over five random splits the slope averages 0.97 (SE about 0.13); the lower leverage terciles carry too little contrast to estimate a slope.

Other yardsticks. On the pitches with a Statcast contrast (the others are dropped from the stream, so the inventory runs over a shortened season rather than the full one), the whole

analysis on Statcast's stakes (comparator refitted on all games, DP re-solved, every policy re-simulated; neither cross-fitted nor out-of-fold) gives a gap of 0.75; deciding on our full-season stakes and scoring every flip at Statcast's contrast gives 0.72, against 0.74 decided and scored on ours. Every rule keeps its rank.

Where the cross-fitting effect comes from. On two cross-fit splits, with common random numbers, the comparator was evaluated with decisions on the full-season or the out-of-fold engine and scores at the full-season or the in-fold engine (`crossfit.py decomp`). The gap is 0.69 deciding and scoring on the full-season engine, 0.70 scoring the same decisions on the in-fold engine, 0.69 deciding on the out-of-fold engine and scoring on the full-season one, and 0.66 cross-fitted: the drop appears only when decision and score use independent engines. A single split's scoring engine adds noise of about ± 0.02 to the gap, which the average over 8 splits removes.

S5.9. *The intervention grid.* For a perceptual share ρ the simulated player sees $s_p = w + \sqrt{\rho}\,\sigma_r \varepsilon_1$; the belief map is fitted on auxiliary draws of s_p, so the benchmark's belief is calibrated to the player's own signal; the teams' behavioural rule decides on $s_p + \sqrt{1-\rho}\,\sigma_r \varepsilon_2$, so that its decision noise is the fitted σ_r for every ρ (Proposition 1(d); in Mathematica, the convolution is exactly $N(0, \sigma_r^2)$ and $\partial \mathbb{P}(\text{challenge} \mid w)/\partial \rho = 0$, `wolfram/intervention.wl`). For a removable lapse share ℓ, the benchmark lapses on a pitch iff $u < (1-\ell)\lambda$, with the same uniform u that decides the behavioural rule's lapse ($u < \lambda$), and its DP is re-solved with the lapsed opportunities worth zero. The grid of Table 5 is part of the full policy cross-fit of the primary model and the comparator ($S = 8$ splits). Table S23 gives the grid for the models of Table 1 without game-state terms, with the stakes cross-fitted only, on one split ($R = 6$; Monte Carlo standard errors about 0.01).

TABLE S23

The accounting gap with the stakes cross-fitted only, one split, by model and intervention (the earlier estimator; primary values of Table 5 come from the full policy cross-fit).

Model (ℓ)	$\rho = 1$	$\rho = 0.75$	$\rho = 0.5$	$\rho = 0.25$
Comparator	0.65	1.06	1.64	2.71
Comparator + lapse ($\ell = 0$)	0.48	0.81	1.34	2.27
Comparator + lapse ($\ell = 0.5$)	0.64	1.01	1.59	2.59
Comparator + lapse ($\ell = 1$)	0.82	1.21	1.83	2.91
Player effects	0.73	1.12	1.74	2.82
Player effects + lapse (primary) ($\ell = 0$)	0.56	0.92	1.44	2.38
Player effects + lapse (primary) ($\ell = 0.5$)	0.74	1.12	1.67	2.68
Player effects + lapse (primary) ($\ell = 1$)	0.90	1.31	1.92	3.00
Comparator, time-varying	0.65	1.07	1.64	2.71
Comparator, time-varying + lapse ($\ell = 0$)	0.50	0.84	1.36	2.30
Comparator, time-varying + lapse ($\ell = 0.5$)	0.65	1.03	1.59	2.59
Comparator, time-varying + lapse ($\ell = 1$)	0.80	1.22	1.82	2.89

In a one-opportunity problem with a Gaussian prior on w, the value of the calibrated cutoff decision falls monotonically in the signal noise at every point of a grid of priors, stakes and continuation values (exact numerical integration in Mathematica), which is the Blackwell ordering behind "the primary intervention gives the smallest benchmark value within a model". The grid stops at $\rho = 0.25$; the gap keeps rising as $\rho \to 0$ (perfect perception), so the largest value on the grid is not an upper end of anything.

S5.10. *The full policy cross-fit.* The headline estimator of Section 6 (code in src/policy _crossfit.py) runs, for each of S random splits of the games into $K = 5$ folds and each fold k: (1) the WP engine on the Statcast games of the other folds (pooling weight scaled to their share), whose stakes are the decision stakes of every pitch, and an engine on fold k alone, whose signed contrast scores fold k; (2) the half-inning and extra-inning run laws from the other folds; (3) the decision model by maximum likelihood on the other folds' opportunities with their decision stakes, from a warm start at the full-sample estimate (for the primary model L-BFGS and Newton steps on a finite-difference Hessian, as for the full-sample fit), and for the primary model the players' posteriors on those opportunities (a player not seen there has effect zero; such players account for 0.04% of the batters' and 0.08% of the fielding side's held-out opportunities); (4) for each simulated world, an auxiliary draw on the other folds' pitches, from which the per-cell belief maps are fitted (cells by side, zone region, the player's noise quintile for the primary model, count class and stake tercile, with the tercile cut points of the other folds); the score-aware DP on the other folds' pools and half-inning counts, re-solved for the lapses the benchmark keeps; and the value of every one-line constant on the other folds, whose maximiser is the frozen constant; (5) on fold k, truths and signals from the training fit, the training map of each pitch's cell applied to its signal, and every policy run along the recorded stream with the training DP and constants. For the primary model each world draws the players' effects jointly from the training posteriors ($J = 4$ joint draws, R/J worlds each). The point is the mean over splits; the split SD is 0.018 (primary) and 0.014 (comparator), the Monte Carlo SE within a split 0.013 and 0.012. The (ρ, ℓ) grid reuses each fold's fits and draws its own worlds.

The simulated behavioural rule skips a pitch whose calibrated belief is zero, as every policy does; in a simulated season this removes a handful of its roughly ten thousand challenges and does not change its value.

Competitor and re-tuned rules (Table 4, $S = 8$ splits). On the training folds of each split: the runs-objective rule's token values (the DP with run values as stakes, at the start of each half-inning); the 48-cell card's stake terciles and, for the refitted card, each cell's median break-even of the training DP; the run cost of Savant's form (best of 0.02–0.2 runs on the training draws); and the teams' criterion $s > \kappa(x)$ re-tuned per side by adding $a + b(\log g - \overline{\log g})$, with a on a grid of -3 to 1 in and b on -2 to 0.5 in per unit of $\log g$ ("intercept": a only; "slope": b only; "both": a coordinate search over b, then a, then b). Each tuned object is then applied unchanged to the held-out games, played by the same simulated player as the benchmark (the same lapses).

The layers of optimism, for the comparator: in-sample at the full-season stakes 0.70, stakes cross-fitted only 0.65 (decision engine without the pitch's fold, decision model, beliefs and DP on all games), full policy cross-fit 0.63.

S5.11. *Bootstrap and coverage.*

Refit bootstrap of the full policy cross-fit. The resampling unit is the game. Each replicate draws the 2,425 games with replacement with their Statcast records and runs the whole procedure of Section S5.10 on the resample with one random split, folds drawn over the original games ($R = 8$ worlds). For the primary model every fold refits all 41 hyperparameters from a warm start at the full-sample estimate and recomputes the players' posteriors: $5B = 2{,}000$ refits of the 11×11-node likelihood (all fold fits reached the gradient tolerance). Primary: percentile [0.40, 0.66], basic [0.35, 0.61], normal [0.38, 0.63], bootstrap SD 0.064, mean 0.53 ($B = 400$). Comparator: percentile [0.48, 0.73], basic [0.53, 0.79], normal [0.51, 0.76], SD 0.063, mean 0.61 ($B = 400$). The bootstrap mean differs from the point because a resample has about $1 - e^{-1} \approx 63\%$ distinct games: each training fold learns the engine, the beliefs and the DP from fewer distinct games, and the players' posteriors from duplicated data. The two

effects push in different directions, and the mean lies above the point for the primary model and below it for the comparator. Split and simulation noise (one split and $R = 8$ per replicate) account for 12% of the primary bootstrap variance (9% for the comparator); without them the bootstrap SD would be 0.060 and 0.060. Of the comparator's replicates, 22 have a fold whose fit stopped at the iteration limit (`trust-exact`, 60 iterations); the interval without them differs by at most 0.002.

The stakes-only cross-fit. Cross-fitting only the stakes, the comparator's joint bootstrap (one game resample drives the engine, the stakes, the run laws, the decision-model refit, the beliefs and the DP; $B = 395$, $R = 10$) gives [0.52, 0.76] around 0.65, and a block bootstrap over home-team months ($B = 100$) [0.54, 0.78].

Coverage. Each simulated season keeps the real 2026 game stream and simulates the challenges from a generating model (truth from the zone rule with the mislabel rate, signal and criterion from the generating model's parameters — for the primary model every player at his posterior mean —, lapses, the challenges each simulated team holds); the analysis is the full policy cross-fit and its refit bootstrap. The cross-fit's target θ_K is computed under each generating model by learning the benchmark on (K−1)/K of a simulated season exactly as the analysis does and valuing it in the generating model's world at the full-season stakes (averaged over 10–16 seasons), minus the mean realised value of 20 behaviour draws; the oracle gap uses a benchmark at the generating parameters instead. Primary model analysing its own data (30 seasons, $B = 30$, $R = 8$): $\theta_K = 0.57$, oracle 0.65; percentile coverage of θ_K 80% [61, 92], basic 80%, normal 100%; point bias against θ_K 0.009 (SE 0.011), point SD across seasons 0.061 against a mean bootstrap SD of 0.063. Comparator ($B = 50$, $R = 4$) on data from itself (50 seasons; $\theta_K = 0.69$): coverage of θ_K by the percentile, basic and normal intervals 92%, 88% and 90%, bias −0.032; from the lapse model (30 seasons; $\theta_K = 0.52$): percentile 10%, normal 10%, bias 0.212; from the primary model (30 seasons; $\theta_K = 0.58$): percentile 37%, normal 27%, bias 0.160. Primary model analysing data from player effects without lapses (12 seasons, $B = 20$, $R = 8$; $\theta_K = 0.71$): percentile 92%, normal 100%, bias −0.001. The percentile misses of the primary analysis lie on the high side and the basic misses on the low side, as the shifted bootstrap location predicts; the normal interval, which uses only the bootstrap's spread, is the one reported. A study on resampled streams, of the stakes-only estimator, repeated games inside a season and biased its point down; keeping the real stream removes that artefact, but it also leaves the game-resampling component of the interval unchecked. In the generating models of the primary model every player sits at his posterior mean, which understates the heterogeneity of the fitted population law.

Calibration on the selected pitches. Across R draws, the realised stake-weighted success over the pitches the benchmark challenges exceeds the stake-weighted belief by 0.1% (0.4% for the one-line rule), an aggregate check that cannot rule out state-dependent miscalibration that partly cancels.

The WP engine. Its Brier score for the game outcome over all plate appearances is 0.1585, against 0.1585 for Statcast's own win expectancy (correlation 0.9996). It has no home-field term; adding one changes the wins lost by -0.003 (Section S5.4).

S5.12. *Further checks.*

The teams' rule, re-tuned. Table S24 keeps the teams' fitted criterion $s > \kappa(x)$, with the challenges the simulated team holds, and re-tunes one part of it at a time on 10 simulated worlds; the values are on 10 other worlds (comparator, stakes cross-fitted only, one split, with 95% intervals from 60 joint-bootstrap replicates; the full-policy cross-fit values of the re-tuned rules are in Table 4). "Slope re-tuned" replaces the stake part of κ by a linear term in $\log g$ with a tuned slope by side; "stake terms scaled" multiplies the fitted stake part by a tuned factor. All these rules use only the signal in inches and observable state.

TABLE S24

Re-tuning the teams' fitted rule, wins per team-season, out of the tuning sample (comparator). Gap closed: share of the gap between observed play and the benchmark.

Rule	Wins	Share of benchmark (%)	Gap closed (%)	Challenges per team-game
Teams' fitted rule $s > \kappa(x)$	3.29	82.4	-6	2.15
Intercept re-tuned (frequency)	3.68	92.1	53	2.93
Slope on $\log g$ re-tuned (targeting)	3.87	96.9	81	2.45
Intercept and slope re-tuned	3.87	96.9	82	2.39
Stake terms scaled	3.79	94.9	69	2.33
Intercept and stake terms scaled	3.86	96.5	79	2.53

Losses over the season. Table S25 gives the wins lost by calendar month at the point estimate, each scaled to a full team-season, with game-bootstrap standard errors at fixed parameters.

TABLE S25

Wins lost per team-season equivalent by period (comparator, $R = 40$ draws).

Period	Games	Wins lost (SE)	Observed share of optimum (%)	One-line rule share (%)
Mar/Apr	466	0.92 (0.14)	77.5	95.9
May	419	0.91 (0.15)	77.3	94.7
Jun	394	0.46 (0.15)	88.1	95.1
Jul	371	0.61 (0.14)	84.7	94.9
Aug	415	0.78 (0.14)	82.3	95.6
Sep	360	0.41 (0.14)	89.4	95.6
Before the All-Star break	1,442	0.77 (0.08)	80.5	95.1
After it	983	0.59 (0.09)	85.9	95.6
Season	2,425	0.70 (0.06)	82.8	95.3

Stakes. Table S26 rebuilds the WP engine with other shrinkage of the plate-appearance transitions (decision-model parameters fixed, $R = 10$); the selection optimism of scoring a policy on the stakes it selected on is removed by the cross-fitting of Section 6. Calls made moot by an inning-ending out on the same pitch (a caught stealing for the third out, say) still carry a stake; there are 271, with 0.07% of the total stake and one challenge.

TABLE S26

Engine shrinkage: wins lost, the one-line rule's share and the called pitches (and distinct engine states) in which a ball is worth less than a strike to the batting team.

Engine	Wins lost	One-line rule share (%)	Non-monotone pitches	Non-monotone cells
Pooled over counts, weight 20 (main)	0.69	95.5	331	172
No shrinkage	0.69	95.5	306	162
Pooled over counts, weight 100	0.68	95.1	642	313
Toward the 0–0 table, weight 20	0.69	95.4	308	161

Beliefs at the boundary. The isotonic belief map can return $p = 0$ or $p = 1$, outside $[\pi, 1 - \pi]$; per draw about 233 opportunities get $p = 1$ and 95,191 get $p < \pi$. Clipping p to $[\pi, 1 - \pi]$ changes the wins lost by less than 10^{-9} and the one-line rule's share not at all, because those pitches are either certain challenges or worthless ones under both maps.

S6. The 2026 postseason.

S6.1. *Sample and design.* We use the 33 postseason games completed by 17 October 2026 (Table S27); the World Series is not included. The data are built exactly as for the regular season, on Statcast's 2026 coordinates as published, and the zone rule reproduces every postseason ruling; no challenge is made with none left. Every model parameter, the isotonic belief map and the score-aware DP come from the regular season. Postseason data enter only the explicitly labelled postseason refits.

TABLE S27

The 2026 postseason by round, and the regular season for comparison. Challenges are those on pitches with a Statcast location (all 10,557 regular-season challenges are located); the catcher column includes pitchers.

	Games	Called pitches	Challenges	Per team-game	Batter	Catcher, pitcher	Overturned (%)
Wild Card	9	1,315	41	2.28	16	25	58.5
Division Series	16	2,431	80	2.50	35	45	58.8
LCS	8	1,145	35	2.19	9	26	68.6
Postseason	33	4,891	156	2.36	60	96	60.9
Regular season	2,425	370,762	10,557	2.18	4,766	5,791	53.9

S6.2. *Decision-model transfer.* Table S28 compares observed with predicted challenges. The challenge log-score skill is $1 - \ell/\ell_0$, where ℓ is the mean log score of the challenge

TABLE S28

The 2026 postseason through 17 October, with the regular-season model held fixed unless stated. Log-score skill: improvement of the challenge log score over a constant challenge probability. Intervals are 95% intervals from the asymptotic normal law of the refitted parameters; the benchmark's thresholds have slope 0.58 (batters) and 0.59 (catchers) on $\log g$ *in the same regression.*

	Batters	Catchers and pitchers
Challenges, observed / predicted (z)	60 / 61.5 (-0.2)	96 / 79.6 ($+2.2$)
predicted from a post-All-Star-break fit (z)	62.4 (-0.3)	88.4 ($+1.0$)
Challenge log-score skill, postseason / regular season	0.38 / 0.30	0.46 / 0.42
σ_r (in), postseason refit / regular season	2.69 [2.43, 2.97] / 2.88	1.93 [1.75, 2.13] / 1.82
Threshold slope on $\log g$, postseason refit / regular season	0.06 [-0.06, 0.18] / 0.08	0.04 [-0.08, 0.17] / 0.04

decision on eligible pitches and ℓ_0 that of a constant probability equal to the model's mean. With a deterministic truth the overturn rate given a challenge checks only the geometry, and it is reproduced exactly. Refitting both σ_r and the criterion's intercept on the postseason shifts the catchers' criterion by -0.34 [-0.70, 0.03] in, which absorbs their extra challenges (batters: -0.53 [-1.22, 0.17] in), and gives σ_r of 2.39 [1.98, 2.89] and 1.73 [1.48, 2.03] in, whose intervals overlap the regular-season ones.

S6.3. *Learning.* Table S29 applies the full-season regular-season model to each period's opportunities, so observed against predicted isolates behaviour from the opportunity mix. Batters challenge at a steady rate per eligible pitch. Catchers challenged less than the model predicts before the All-Star break (14 July) and more after it, and the postseason continues the second-half rate.

S6.4. *Series stakes.* Challenges do not carry over between games. With a coin-flip series model, the probability of winning the series is $P(\text{series} \mid \text{lose}) + L\,P(\text{win game})$, where $L = P(\text{series} \mid \text{win}) - P(\text{series} \mid \text{lose})$ is fixed within a game. Maximising series win probability within a game is therefore exactly maximising game win probability: series stakes are game

TABLE S29
Challenges per 100 eligible pitches and observed against predicted challenges, full-season model.

Period	Games	Challenges per 100 eligible pitches		Observed / predicted (z)	
		batter	catcher	batter	catcher
Before the All-Star break	1,442	4.66	3.82	2,811 / 2832.6 (-0.5)	3,230 / 3481.2 (-5.1)
After the All-Star break	983	4.83	4.53	1,955 / 1927.0 ($+0.7$)	2,561 / 2293.1 ($+6.7$)
Postseason	33	4.42	5.02	60 / 61.5 (-0.2)	96 / 79.6 ($+2.2$)

stakes scaled by the factor $L \leq 1$, which scales g and the continuation value Δ together and leaves the cutoff (3) unchanged. A stake-rational threshold should not move with L. Refitting the criterion on $\log(gL)$ instead of $\log g$ fits no better ($-\log$-likelihood 360.56 against 358.37 at the same parameter count), and the excess challenges in the 14 games with $L \geq 0.5$ are not significant ($z = +1.1$ for batters and $+1.3$ for catchers).

S6.5. *Value.* Table S30 evaluates the policies by path sum with the regular-season belief map and DP ($R = 20$ draws), in game win probability per team-game. The postseason interval is a game bootstrap ($B = 2000$) at fixed regular-season parameters; it omits parameter uncertainty, which is small next to the sampling noise of 33 games. Weighted by series leverage, the loss is 0.0007 [-0.0015, 0.0025] series win probability per team-game.

TABLE S30
Value of challenges in game win probability per team-game (challenges per team-game in parentheses), 95% game-bootstrap interval for the postseason.

Policy	Regular season	Postseason
Transported benchmark (regular-season DP)	0.0248 (2.70)	0.0254 (2.71)
One-line rule, $\delta = 0.008$	0.0237 (2.23)	0.0249 (2.33)
Fitted behavioural rule (simulated)	0.0205 (2.16)	0.0208 (2.08)
Observed (realised)	0.0207 (2.18)	0.0238 (2.36)
Benchmark − observed	0.0041	0.0017 [-0.0034, 0.0061]
Share of the benchmark captured (%)	84	94 [74, 113]

S7. Cricket's Decision Review System: an exploratory application. This application lacks the device that identifies the MLB model: the ball-tracking truth is not public, so the truth enters as a latent margin, the perception noise is identified only through the shape of the review curve and the share of umpire's calls, and the results below are exploratory. For an economic analysis of DRS decisions see Shivakumar (2018).

S7.1. *Data and review allowances.* We use Cricsheet ball-by-ball data (Rushe, 2026): men's Tests, ODIs and T20 internationals from October 2017 and the IPL from 2018, with T20 internationals and IPL pooled as "T20". A match is in the sample if it has a recorded review, or none but another match of the same competition, event and season between the same teams or at the same city has one (DRS is set per series and host); matches that Cricsheet flags as missing their review records are excluded (Table S31). Keeping only matches with a review would select on the behaviour being modelled. ODIs have more zero-review matches than a Poisson count of reviews implies, so some of the added ODIs may have been played without DRS; Cricsheet does not record it. Reviews follow the ICC playing conditions: from October 2017 a review that ends in umpire's call is kept; Tests allow two unsuccessful reviews per innings, ODIs and T20 internationals one; from July 2020 the interim regulations add

one in every format; the IPL allows one until 2021 and two from 2022. We reconstruct the reviews each side holds from these rules. The data agree with them half-year by half-year: the maximum number of unsuccessful reviews per side and innings equals the allowance in every half-year and competition, and only 2 of 8,440 reviews are taken with none left. An independent recount from the raw files reproduces every count in Table S31.

TABLE S31

DRS data. DRS matches include the zero-review matches of DRS series (Section S7). Batting-side out decisions are every LBW, caught or caught-and-bowled out decision, including those overturned on review.

	Test	ODI	T20
DRS matches	331	623	1,331
Batting-side out decisions	8,683	6,738	12,246
of which LBW	1,497	824	862
Batting reviews	1,822	809	914
overturned / umpire's call / lost	642 / 377 / 803	310 / 146 / 353	321 / 165 / 428
Fielding reviews	2,326	1,092	1,477
overturned / umpire's call / lost	456 / 350 / 1520	263 / 149 / 680	329 / 188 / 960

S7.2. *Model and likelihood.* On the batting side the opportunity set is observed: every out decision could be reviewed. A decision of kind k (LBW or caught) has a latent margin $X \sim N(\mu_k, 1)$ and is overturned on review iff $X > 0$. A failed LBW review is kept (umpire's call) iff the margin is marginal, $-\kappa < X < 0$, and lost iff $X \le -\kappa$; a failed caught review is always lost. The batter sees $S = X + \varepsilon$, $\varepsilon \sim N(0, s^2)$, so s is perception noise in units of the spread of decision margins, and holds the Bayes posterior

$$X \mid S \sim N(m, v), \quad m = \frac{\mu_k s^2 + S}{1 + s^2}, \quad v = \frac{s^2}{1 + s^2}, \qquad p = \mathbb{P}(X > 0 \mid S) = \Phi(m/\sqrt{v}).$$

Since p is increasing in S, reviewing iff $p \ge \tau$ is reviewing iff $S \ge S^*(\tau) = (1 + s^2)\sqrt{v}\,\Phi^{-1}(\tau) - \mu_k s^2$. The revealed threshold τ is estimated per cell of reviews left and wickets down (0–2, 3–5, 6–9). With $q = \mathbb{P}(S \ge S^*)$ and the orthant probability $J(t) = \mathbb{P}(X > t, S \ge S^*) = \Phi_2\{\mu_k - t, (\mu_k - S^*)/(1 + s^2)^{1/2}; (1 + s^2)^{-1/2}\}$, the likelihood of an out decision is

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{not reviewed:} \quad 1 - q, && \text{overturned:} \quad J(0), \\ &\text{umpire's call:} \quad J(-\kappa) - J(0), && \text{lost:} \quad q - J(-\kappa) \ \ (\text{caught: } q - J(0)), \end{aligned}$$

mixed over kinds with the LBW share for overturned decisions, whose kind is not recorded. The "constant-rate" alternative keeps a failed LBW review with probability ρ, independent of X. Every closed form is checked in Section S2.

Identification. Outcome rates identify the review share, success rate and umpire's-call share in every cell, the share of wrong LBW decisions and the band κ (Table S32). Perception noise is harder. As τ moves across cells, the review, success and umpire's-call shares trace one curve whose shape bounds s from below; the umpire's-call channel adds information because it tells how close the reviewed decisions were. Without it (constant-rate model) the likelihood is flat above $s \approx 0.5$. With it, the fitted s is consistent with the data in Tests and T20 and weakly identified in ODIs. The upper bound is soft even in Tests and T20: in known-truth recovery from the fitted model ($R = 20$ replicates per format) the estimate exceeds 1 in 15–40% of replicates, although the profile-likelihood interval keeps close to its nominal coverage. The intervals are continuous profile-likelihood intervals from multi-start fits.

TABLE S32
DRS selection model, batting side, and known-truth recovery of s.

	Test	ODI	T20
Perception noise $\hat{s}$ (margin SD)	0.47	0.81	0.45
95% profile-likelihood interval	[0.4, 0.8]	[0.4, 2.3]	[0.4, 0.9]
Umpire's-call band $\hat{\kappa}$	0.48	0.41	0.40
LBW out decisions that are wrong (%)	30.3	29.0	27.8
Caught out decisions that are wrong (%)	0.08	0.14	0.02
Constant-rate model: $P(\text{kept} \mid \text{failed})$	0.36	0.31	0.31
Known truth: median $\hat{s}$ (truth = fitted $\hat{s}$)	0.50	0.78	0.64
replicates with $\hat{s} > 1$	4/20	8/20	3/20
coverage of the 95% LR set (%)	90	95	90

S7.3. *Dynamic program and policies.* The win-probability engine for each format is gradient boosting with monotone constraints, without recalibration: an isotonic map fitted on held-out matches and scored on other ones does not improve the Brier score (it slightly worsens it in Tests), so the stakes use the engine's own predictions; Tests use expected match points (win $+\frac{1}{2}$ draw). The stake g of a decision is the change in match value from one more wicket at that state. The DP state is wickets down w and reviews left c within a batting innings. From w the next event is a reviewable out decision (probability a_w), another wicket (b_w) or the end of the innings, with rates estimated from the real innings. With $U(w, c)$ the expected stake recovered by reviews from (w, c),

$$U(w,c) = a_w \mathbb{E}\max\big\{U(w+1,c),\ p\,(g + U(w,c)) + (1-p)U(w+1,c) - \ell\,\Delta U\big\} + b_w U(w+1,c),$$

with $\Delta U = U(w+1,c) - U(w+1,c-1)$ and ℓ the posterior probability that the review is lost. It is optimal to review iff $p(g + A) \geq \ell\,\Delta U$, $A = U(w,c) - U(w+1,c)$. Policies are simulated on the real decision streams: the benchmark, the best one-line rule $p \geq \delta/(g+\delta)$, teams' fitted revealed rule, and $p \geq 0.5$; the realised value of the real reviews is reported alongside. Uncertainty comes from a match bootstrap with $B = 500$ that refits the selection model, re-solves the DP and re-simulates.

S7.4. *Results.* Table S33 gives the values in match points per 100 team-matches. The one-line rule is within about one percent of the benchmark in every format. As in MLB, the primary comparison is the benchmark against realised play: in Tests teams lose 0.13 [−0.27, 0.49] match points per 100 team-matches, an interval that contains zero. Against teams' fitted rule simulated on the same draws as the benchmark the loss is 0.020. The two differ by the luck of which decisions were actually overturned and by how well the fitted rule reproduces realised play; here the fitted rule's value lies inside the interval of the realised value, so the two comparisons tell the same story (in MLB they do under the comparator but not under the primary model; Section 7). The benchmark reviews more often than teams do, but with $\hat{s} \approx 0.5$ the posteriors are nearly bimodal and the extra reviews are of decisions with $p \approx 0$, worth almost nothing either way: within the fitted model and at its point estimate of the noise there is no detectable counterpart to MLB's loss, but the noise is weakly identified and the losses are not robust across its profile interval.

Table S34 gives the optimal LBW threshold (posterior probability that the decision is wrong, in percent) at each number of wickets down. With one review left it falls steadily from the top order to the tail; with two it is near zero throughout. Table S35 fits the value of the last review against the expected out decisions left, N. A linear fit beats $\sqrt{N}$ in every format and

TABLE S33
DRS, batting side: match points per 100 team-matches, 95% match-bootstrap intervals ($B = 500$).

	Test	ODI	T20
Benchmark	5.61 [5.03, 6.21]	2.28 [2.00, 2.79]	0.96 [0.85, 1.08]
One-line rule	5.60 ($\delta = 0.001$)	2.24 ($\delta = 0.005$)	0.96 ($\delta = 0.0005$)
share of benchmark (%)	99.8 [99.3, 100.0]	98.5 [96.1, 99.9]	99.5 [98.9, 100.1]
Teams' fitted rule (simulated)	5.59	2.26	0.96
Observed (realised)	5.47 [4.92, 6.11]	2.28 [1.99, 2.62]	0.94 [0.82, 1.06]
Review iff $p \geq 0.5$	4.30	1.42	0.75
Lost vs fitted rule	0.020 [0.006, 0.067]	0.018 [−0.008, 0.394]	0.001 [−0.002, 0.008]
Lost vs realised	0.13 [−0.27, 0.49]	0.00 [−0.13, 0.44]	0.02 [−0.04, 0.09]
Reviews per team-match: benchmark / rule / observed	4.44 / 1.93 / 2.75	1.02 / 0.59 / 0.65	0.48 / 0.28 / 0.35

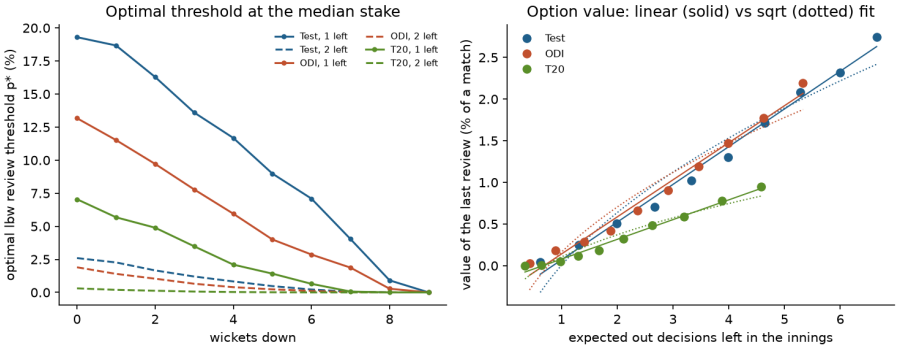


FIG S3. *DRS, exploratory application, batting side, by format.*

the power exponent is well above $1/2$: with five to seven out decisions per innings on average and about 30.3% of LBW out decisions wrong, the last review is worth roughly the expected errors ahead times the stake. Exponents above one cannot come from the stationary model of Theorem S2, where the increments $\Delta_t(1) - \Delta_{t-1}(1) = \varphi(\Delta_{t-1}(1))$ are non-increasing (Lemma S1 with Theorem 2(b)) and growth is at most linear; they reflect stakes and decision rates that change with the wickets down. The square-root law is a statement about a long stationary horizon whose confidence law has mass up to certainty with the tail of Theorem S2; a batting innings, with a handful of decisions whose stakes change with the wickets down, is far from that regime.

TABLE S34
Optimal LBW review threshold (%) by wickets down and reviews left.

Wickets down	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Test, 1 left	19.3	18.7	16.3	13.6	11.7	9.0	7.1	4.0	0.9	0.0
Test, 2 left	2.6	2.3	1.7	1.2	0.8	0.5	0.2	0.0	0.0	0.0
ODI, 1 left	13.2	11.5	9.7	7.8	6.0	4.0	2.9	1.9	0.3	0.0
ODI, 2 left	1.9	1.4	1.0	0.7	0.4	0.2	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.0
T20, 1 left	7.0	5.7	4.9	3.5	2.1	1.4	0.6	0.1	0.0	0.0
T20, 2 left	0.3	0.2	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0

S7.5. *Sensitivity and limitations.* Table S36 varies perception noise, the umpire's-call model, the WP engine and the stakes. Losses become material only if perception is poor

TABLE S35
Value of the last review against the out decisions left.

	Test	ODI	T20
R^2 of Δ_1 on $\sqrt{N}$	0.940	0.923	0.934
R^2 of Δ_1 on N	0.989	0.985	0.988
Power exponent [95% CI]	1.66 [1.51, 1.80]	1.67 [1.49, 1.86]	1.85 [1.57, 2.13]
Expected out decisions left at the start, N	6.65	5.33	4.58

($s = 2$), which the likelihood rejects in Tests and T20 but not in ODIs, where the no-loss conclusion rests on the point estimate of s. The one-line rule stays within a few percent of the benchmark in every variant. On the fielding side only reviews are observed; not-out appeals that were not reviewed leave no trace, so the opportunity set, the benchmark and the loss cannot be estimated. Descriptively, fielding reviews succeed in 20, 24 and 22% of cases (Test, ODI, T20) and end in umpire's call in 15, 14 and 13%.

TABLE S36
DRS sensitivity, batting side: benchmark / lost vs fitted rule / one-line rule's share of the benchmark (%), match points per 100 team-matches. $-\Delta\ell$: profile log-likelihood loss of s.

	Test	ODI	T20
Main (band model, $\hat{s}$)	5.61 / 0.020 / 99.8	2.28 / 0.018 / 98.5	0.96 / 0.001 / 99.5
Upper end of the s set	5.60 / 0.053 / 98.7 ($s = 0.84$)	2.96 / 0.726 / 93.8 ($s = 2.28$)	0.97 / 0.016 / 99.2 ($s = 0.86$)
$s = 2$	6.64 / 1.173 / 95.5 ($-\Delta\ell = 5.21$)	2.79 / 0.550 / 93.8 ($-\Delta\ell = 1.57$)	1.38 / 0.452 / 93.8 ($-\Delta\ell = 4.46$)
Constant-rate umpire's call	5.39 / 0.032 / 99.7	2.33 / 0.023 / 99.5	0.96 / 0.000 / 99.8
Recalibrated WP engine	5.70 / 0.022 / 99.8	2.32 / 0.017 / 98.5	1.01 / 0.002 / 99.5
Stakes $\times 1.5$	8.41 / 0.030 / 99.9	3.42 / 0.027 / 98.5	1.44 / 0.002 / 99.5
Stakes $\times 0.67$	3.76 / 0.013 / 99.9	1.53 / 0.012 / 98.3	0.64 / 0.001 / 99.6

Limitations. The WP engines are league-average, with no team strength or conditions. The Gaussian margin model is parametric, and its shape beyond the observed thresholds is assumed. The DP pools stakes by wickets down, so overs left and declarations enter only through the empirical rates. The counterfactual keeps the real decision stream fixed: a batter reprieved in simulation creates no new decisions, the same approximation as the MLB path sum, and there is no causal re-simulation for DRS; solving the DP without the extra opportunity after a successful review, so that DP and evaluation share one process, moves the benchmark by at most a few thousandths of a match point. The best δ chosen on one half of the matches by date and scored on the other keeps 98–100% of the benchmark.

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